

A PROMISE TO MOM · DEEP BUYER RESEARCH

Home Care Industry — Deep Buyer Research

The adult daughter arranging in-home care for an aging parent. Tabs 1–10, threads and competitors, the complaints ledger, and the ad brief.

Researched 2026-09-06 · refreshed 2026-09-07 · exported 2026-09-08

Corpus 15,867 entries · 230 sourced quotes · 18,392 Meta ads analyzed

Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/home-care-industry/research/>

Companion file: Home-Care-Buyer-Research-Voices (every theme's most engaged comments, with replies)

A Promise to Mom · the adult daughter arranging in-home care for an aging parent · national + Atlanta, Houston, Phoenix, Chicago, Tampa

Researched 2026-09-06, refreshed 2026-09-07, exported 2026-09-08. Corpus 15,867 entries · 230 sourced quotes in the tabs · 18,392 Meta ads analyzed. Live page with clickable themes, competitor ads and reviews by star: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/home-care-industry/research/>

This document is the Sabri Suby 10-tab buyer research (Tabs 1–10) plus the depth layer (threads, vocabulary, profile pivot, competitor map, self-audit), the dislikes and complaints ledger, and Vince's ad brief checked against the corpus. Every quote is verbatim and carries its source URL. Every count was computed by a script over the corpus, not estimated. The companion file *Home-Care-Buyer-Research-Voices* holds, for every measured theme, the twenty most engaged comments in full with their replies.

Buyer: the adult child, in the corpus a daughter about 4 times as often as a son, arranging in-home non-medical care for a parent. Measured from self-stated ages: poster median 57 (n=237; 27% under 45, 43% 45–64, 30% 65+); cared-for parent median 85 (n=431; 53% are 85 or older), a mother 274 times to a father 98

Plain-language TL;DR: She buys home care in the week after a discharge or a fall, not because of an ad; the guilt of the promise and her own exhaustion are what she is carrying when she does. When she buys, the four things that decide whether she stays are: the aide shows up, it is the same aide, the office answers at 3am, and nobody makes her buy four hours to get one. No advertiser in the category sells those four things. Home Instead sells the fifth, "you are not a bad daughter," and it is the market leader.

Ordering rules: quotes inside a tab by engagement (upvotes or likes) descending, then reading order for reviews without a vote count; every frequency, complaint, product, desire and vocabulary table by document count descending; thread cards by corpus document count descending; headlines by theme document count then engagement; competitor tables by the stated score; advertiser groups on the page by top-performer count, then best impressions rank, then longest-running ad.

Voices by theme (added 2026-09-07 after Vince's note that the tabs left too much behind): the twenty-odd quotes in each tab are a curated set, not the corpus. Under every tab on the page, clickable themes open up to 20 of the most engaged comments on that theme with their replies (YouTube threads repulled with replies: 5,234 threads, 9,964 comments across the 14 research videos; Reddit posts carry their top comments). The full lists are in `voices-by-theme.md` beside this file.

Reading vs. measurement: every count in this document comes from a script over the corpus (`raw/facts.json`, `frequency_v2.json`, `demographics*.json`, `product_mentions.json`, `complaints.json`, `ad_desires.json`) and was recomputed on 2026-09-07 after the audit that added 119 spin-off posts missing from the corpus. The tab introductions, the thread-card implications, the sales frame and the awareness map are my reading of the quotes and are labeled as such. All 208 quotes were re-verified verbatim against the data files.

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Tab 1 — Fears

Themes, measured

Each theme is one pattern over the whole corpus; the number is how many documents match it. The twenty most engaged voices on each theme, with replies, are in the Voices appendix under Tab 1.

Theme	Documents
Becoming the burden to my own children	74
The system: discharge, Medicaid says no, APS	54
Losing myself: my own health, that she will bury me	49
Losing them: the last time	22
Falls, the ER, the floor	20
Nights and the 3am call	18
The money runs out	18
Being forced to take care of her / her moving in	18
A stranger in the house, theft, trust	15
Dementia: wandering, the stove, not knowing me	14

In her words

What she is afraid of, in her words (the summary sentences are my reading; the counts are measured). The fear is rarely "home care" itself. It is the phone call, the floor, the stairs, the stove, and the version of herself that does not survive this. Falls dominate (299 documents describe a fall, an ER visit or an ambulance in the tightened count; 824 mention the word). The second fear is quieter and bigger: that there is no "her" left at the end of it. Quotes in every tab are ordered by engagement (upvotes or likes) where the platform shows one; reviews and forum answers without a vote count follow in reading order.

"I am 62. I cared for both of my parents for 10 years. It almost killed me. You lose your very self. People tell you to take care of yourself, but there's no time for that. There's no You anymore. My mother was the last one to die. That was 4 years ago. I'm still exhausted, if that tells you anything."

YouTube · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents* · 1,123 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxBCru86SBHWgrVpXB4AaABAg

"Im an only child and am looking after my parents. Its been 10 years and its nearly destroyed me. Its been horrific. Its not what i expected. I thought id would be bringing a meal over and taking them to appointments but the truth is its a living hell. Now Im unwell myself."

YouTube · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents* · 626 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzFmmIzwwUilqQ93KF4AaABAg

"About nine months ago, my mother, then 89, had a catastrophic fall in their house. Her bedroom was on the second floor, and she fell all the way down the stairs and ended up in the ICU for two weeks, and in the hospital for over three months. She's now home and physically almost recovered (miraculously) but has lots of other issues, and her cognition has declined precipitously. So has my dad's, from all the stress, and because he's 92. Their bank accounts are being drained by the 24/7 care they no[w need]"

r/AgingParents · *Rethinking falls* · 336 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/

"It finally got to the point where I couldn't sleep, or shop, or even go to the basement to do laundry, because my mom would wander outside or put her hand down the garbage disposal or put metal in the microwave. I couldn't keep her out of her kitchen, and there are so many things in a kitchen that she could hurt herself with."

YouTube · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents* · 99 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwRjYjRIFbk92-Ub5l4AaABAq

"I convinced her to get a watch with fall detection last year after she fell several times while she was out walking. She keeps saying that it's just because she "wasn't paying attention" but today she fell again and now I'm waiting at the ER while she gets stitches in her forehead... again."

r/AgingParents · *Mom fell... again* · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1btlmzi/mom_fell_again/

"the eight month waitlist while your mom is hallucinating and wandering at night is completely unacceptable and incredibly dangerous."

r/dementia · comment on *I am a dementia nurse and former caregiver* · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzf/c/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/oktgxjr/

"After my dad passed my mom moved to my city as her closest remaining child to help her. After she had a stroke I insisted on Visiting Angels (caregiver agency) and she finally agreed. As time and health issues progressed again I just told her how it'll be when increasing their time. I also made it clear from the start I'll wipe your ass once but if it becomes a need I'll be looking at assisted living."

r/AgingParents · comment on *Adult only child left to pick up the caregiving pieces* · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/ok8an96/

"She told us about falling, lying on the floor for about 2 hours before dragging [herself]"

r/dementia · *Refuses to wear a Fall Alert pendant, so now we are thinking of cameras* · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1djryf/refuses_to_wear_a_fall_alert_pendant_so_now_we/

"I'm so alone, it's all consuming and now I can't sleep past 3am and have at least 3 panic attack's a day. I've moved house to be nearer but my mum fights me on everything and doesn't make it easy while my dad is losing his memory. There's a doctor visit every week I feel with constant worry of wtf is next."

YouTube · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent* · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgysxA1XDFIZ2G0XDMR4AaABAq>

"My dad fell in his garage last week and couldn't get up for 20 minutes until my mom found him. I live 3 hours away and this is exactly what keeps me up at night."

r/AgingParents · *Anyone have experience with medical alert systems that actually work?* · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nfdw3j/anyone_have_experience_with_medical_alert_systems/

"He went home Saturday morning, fell by sliding off the bed that night (~2 am), couldn't get to the phone (he had taken off his Life Alert and couldn't reach that either...). My sister and I were frantically calling him this morning, his helper (Visiting Angels) was coming on Monday. He ended up on the floor for 8 hours until we got ahold of his neighbor"

r/AgingParents · *Round and round we go* · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nbfe8b/round_and_round_we_go/

"I feel like I am drowning and failing my mom. I'm not really sure what I'm looking for by posting this. Maybe advice, maybe support from people who understand. My mom is 62, but her health has been getting worse in multiple ways. She has serious mobility problems, falls, needs help with basic things, and now her memory and thinking are declining too. Her texts are starting to come through garbled or missing words."

r/AgingParents · *I feel like I am drowning and failing my mom* · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ugk009/i_feel_like_i_am_drowning_and_failing_my_mom/

"Now my coworker had caregivers for her mom. It was a nightmare. Constant calling out and the agency would never have a replacement. And yes they stole. She said they all brought in very large bags with them whenever they worked."

AgingCare · *What has your experience been with home care?* · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/what-has-your-experience-been-with-home-care-pros-cons-483152.htm>

"She just stopped showing up one day. She had my house key, too. That's when I learned, through scar tissue, to NOT give out my house key to anyone ever again."

AgingCare · *Home health aide just stopped showing up, could it be theft?* · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/home-health-aide-just-stopped-showing-up-could-it-be-theft-467703.htm>

"Fall detection does not work. My mom has had this device for 3 months and falls multiple times a week. The fall detection has not worked once. I have spent time on the phone troubleshooting and it still never worked. Do not buy this product. My mom is all bruised up"

Amazon · Bay Alarm Medical SOS Micro · 1 star · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R396Z5YMBM5VH5>

Tab 2 — Hopes & Dreams

Themes, measured

Each theme is one pattern over the whole corpus; the number is how many documents match it. The twenty most engaged voices on each theme, with replies, are in the Voices appendix under Tab 2.

Theme	Documents
Pray for strength	307
Hoping it will end soon / wishing they would go	68
Wish I wasn't here anymore (the caregiver's own despair)	43
A peaceful end, no regrets	41
Stay in her own home	22
Peace of mind, sleep again	18
Wish someone had explained / had known	15
To live my own life again	13
Hope for support, for the caregivers	9

In her words

What she wants for her mother and, quietly, for herself. "Stay in her own home" appears 454 times as dignity, independence and aging in place, the fourth most-cited theme after discharge, guilt and burnout. A second hope appears in the quotes below, in her words: to be the daughter again instead of the nurse, and to be able to say afterward "I did the best for her."

"My goal is simple: keep my 92-year-old mom in her own home, surrounded by the life she knows, for as long as I safely can."

TikTok · @nymikeca4718 · 277 comments · <https://www.tiktok.com/@nymikeca4718/video/7676627023950794015>

"I took care of my Mom for her last few years. It was exhausting and frustrating because I got no concrete help from my siblings. But, I did the right thing! She was at peace when she went and she said she didn't know what she would have done without me. Even though it was stressful, it was worth it. I have peace with my soul."

YouTube · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents* · 176 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwdJ3WNa7bqL-UCRKx4AaABAg

"I tried to make his last years of his life as comfortable as possible, it hurts that he is no longer with us, but at least I can say I did the best for him and I am at peace with that."

YouTube · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent* · 125 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgyxSTRKs-uK5z6HW014AaABAg>

"Took my dad into my home when he got early dementia. It was honor and a blessing to take care of my father for ten years. Yes it was hard work but there were also so many delightful memories I will cherish forever. Don't regret it in the least, worth the world to me. He deserved my devotion."

YouTube · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents* · 63 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwITF0AWsJzbdkDE4V4AaABAg

"I put it in writing for my son who has power of attorney that if I can't safely stay at home that he needs to put me in a seniors' home. No guilt. I said don't pay attention if I put up a fuss."

YouTube · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents* · 53 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyxIJPSE5_8x6JY5i94AaABAg

"It finally happened! I never thought the day would come. My 83yo mother finally agreed to go look at assisted living!"

r/AgingParents · *Mom FINALLY went to look at assisted living!* · 51 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2y2el/mom_finally_went_to_look_at_assisted_living/

"She has a phobia of moving. She told me once she'd rather die than move. The more I accept that her wishes are her's then I feel at peace. Yes it's tough to see her ailing and falling at times but that's what she wants is to live in her own home."

YouTube · *My elderly parent refuses help* · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAlAo&lc=UgyD-NVourBhYocww0d4AaABAg>

"the social worker can fast-track her into a facility that contracts with them so you can step back and just be her daughter again"

r/dementia · comment on *I am a dementia nurse and former caregiver* · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/okun25f/

"I wish there was a booking.com for respite. And an whole aged care home dedicated for respite only."

r/CaregiverSupport · comment on *Dear toxic positivity society* · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nocug1y/

"Home Instead has been an incredible blessing for our family. They have given me the priceless gift of peace of mind and the ability to take time for myself without worrying about how my father is being treated or cared for."

Google review · Home Instead, Phoenix · 5 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead&query_place_id=ChIJE-tYoJZrK4cRiYcOgcCrEcg

"When I know she is there with them, I am so very at peace, knowing they are in the best hands."

Google review · Home Instead West and Southwest Houston · 5 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20instead%20-%20West%20and%20Southwest%20Houston&query_place_id=ChIJE92yB9vcQIYRRpNA8t5-1_0

"I want her to be happy because I want her to be healthy. But I also want her to be safe of course."

AgingCare · *My elderly mom is bedridden but of sound mind* · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/my-elderly-mom-is-bedridden-but-of-sound-mind-she-does-not-want-caregivers-overnight-i-am-wondering--485025.htm>

Tab 3 — Relationship Fears

Themes, measured

Each theme is one pattern over the whole corpus; the number is how many documents match it. The twenty most engaged voices on each theme, with replies, are in the Voices appendix under Tab 3.

Theme	Documents
Resentment towards my own parent	242
Only child: no one else to step in	144
When it's your spouse, not your parent	104
Long distance	96
My kids and my job are paying for it	77
Siblings who don't help	44
Marriage strain, separation, divorce	42
What the parent says to me	41
Guilty for wanting my own life / for wanting it to be over	31
Guilty for putting them in a home	24
Guilty for not doing enough / losing my patience	20
The promise I made	19

In her words

The fears that live between people. Three of them: the promise she made (or was asked to make) and cannot keep; the siblings who are not there; and the marriage, job and children that are quietly being spent. 1325 documents mention a sibling or being alone; 214 say outright that the sibling does not help. 610 carry guilt, "the promise" or "bad daughter."

"For those not the person/adult child who is *actually* living with your Aging Parent(s). You have absolutely No Idea. You don't know. You cannot understand. Stop pretending that your facetime and daily texts are doing your part."

r/AgingParents · *I respectfully request.* · 1,039 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/118kypn/i_respectfully_request/

"After several months of a trial separation, my wife yesterday informed me that she wants a divorce. So I feel compelled to issue this warning. Don't get me wrong--I'm not saying my aging father is solely responsible for the dissolution of my marriage. I was dealing with a number of stressors, and her and I failed to resolve issues of some significance. That said, it was obvious my dad's situation played a significant role in all this."

r/AgingParents · *Don't let an aging parent ruin your relationship* · 369 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hvl7z2/dont_let_an_aging_parent_ruin_your_relationship/

"While I know they are necessary, I often feel like the presence of a rotating team of professionals is "replacing" the grandparents we knew. Most frustratingly, since Grandma and Grandpa are still mentally sound, I find it incredibly difficult when the care staff feels the need to manage my visits. It creates a barrier where there should be a bridge"

r/AgingParents · *How would you feel if you had two parents who both required 24/7 assisted care...* · 352 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/

"Did your sister shut him down? If you have a good relationship with her, I would tell her what you overheard, and that unless she starts to push back on his awfulness, she can take over all of the stuff you are presently doing."

r/AgingParents · *Overheard parent saying horrible things about me. I'm the default caretaker. How do I go on?* · 323 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ttnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/op2hs7k/

"My dad does the same. He dumps on my in-laws he barely knows, my husband, the cars we buy, where we live, etc. He has for years but it's especially focused now. He was sending voice clips to me when he was in the hospital that were so mean I asked my husband to sit with me when I listened. When I saw I could just read the transcript that helped a bit. He tells me how nothing I do is as good as other people who live 10-15 minutes away from him. I'm in another state and a 1.5 hour drive away. He threw all my offers to help him in my face, then later said he didn't remember any of that. He's just a really nasty, hateful person and I decided to only help where I can because my tolerance for his crap is so low."

r/AgingParents · *Overheard parent saying horrible things about me. I'm the default caretaker. How do I go on?* · 120 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ttnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/op29a5z/

"At some point, you have to pick living over death. It seems like you have said "I love you" and the eventual passing will not be a surprise. You have already cancelled one vacation. So, if you can go and not feel guilty, and enjoy your vacation, then go. Get prepared for the possibility that some family or friends might try to make you feel guilty. Sounds to me that you have already had a difficult time, and you have earned your rest & relaxation."

r/AgingParents · *Should we cancel a family trip because our dad is dying?* · 113 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tp9u65/should_we_cancel_a_family_trip_because_our_dad_is/oo7367x/

"I (34F) am completely exhausted and need an outside perspective. I (34F) am an only child on my mother's side. My mom has Parkinson's and dementia. My dad is in his 80s and was just hospitalized for a bowel obstruction. I also have a 19-month-old daughter."

r/AgingParents · *AITA for hiring a caregiver for my mom after my family told me it's "my turn to be responsible"?* · 92 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uc225q/aita_for_hiring_a_caregiver_for_my_mom_after_my/

"Moved cross-country to care for my elderly parents because my selfish little brother, who lives a five minute walk from my parents, would not lift a finger to help them. They adored him, as parents should, and looked after his kids for years, but in their hour of need he turned his back. I'm good, they were looked after by me and after 2 years of caring for them they passed within weeks of each other, but I (F59) had to destroy my life to care for them. It almost wrecked my marriage."

YouTube · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents* · 30 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxKf0RtTX8G-Up14Dh4AaABAg

"I feel a small amount of guilt that I don't care for her at home but I have college age kids and a husband who's just retired and wants to travel. I visit several times a week. You reminded me how my mom would not have wanted me to sacrifice my family life for her. Plus I don't have the skills for it."

YouTube · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents* · 23 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxtNyJPdSxxCIX0DQt4AaABAg

"He made me promise him that I wouldn't put him in a facility when his mind was much clearer. I pleaded with my siblings for some help- just a break so my husband and I could go away for a weekend or just out for dinner. Not one offer nor did they even respond to my pleas."

YouTube · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents* · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxoQXDeW75Avvnh114AaABAg

"Then they say "well please promise to never put us in a nursing home". That's not a promise I can make. I cannot predict the future and their health."

AgingCare · *Do parents ask you to promise to never put them into a nursing home?* · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/do-parents-ask-you-to-promise-to-never-put-them-into-a-nursing-home-498143.htm>

"This is one promise I wish people wouldn't make. We can't see into the future and know what kind of illnesses or disabilities await us. My brother made the same promise to my mother and he did not live up to it. I'm not blaming him because none of us had any idea she would have dementia, but I know he feels guilty that she's in assisted living and she feels he broke a promise to her."

AgingCare · *A few years ago I promised my mother not to put her in a nursing home* · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/a-few-years-ago-i-promised-my-mother-not-to-put-her-in-a-nursing-home-444573.htm>

"Promise your mother she will always be care for, but don't promise it will be by you."

AgingCare · *Do parents ask you to promise...* · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/do-parents-ask-you-to-promise-to-never-put-them-into-a-nursing-home-498143.htm>

"I joined a few support groups on Facebook thinking it was a safe space to vent and share my frustration.....and then, apparently a "friend" that knows my sister decided to share my less than complimentary comments with my sister and she called me out. So, I cancelled those groups. My sister, who is always a victim lives five blocks away. She can't find the time or energy to drive two minutes to see our mother, but will always find a way to judge what she thinks I don't do."

YouTube · *The Hidden Burnout Millions of Caregivers Are Facing* · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dZTbJb5Nml8&lc=Ugx2f4rDyRKYCkUOm1N4AaABAg>

"Reading so many comments about how kids who put their sick or dying parents in nursing facilities are heartless and selfish, was really starting to get to me. Especially when I know how much I loved my mom."

YouTube · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents* · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwcCImcl_3X4ucfz8R4AaABAg

"I was especially wary of bringing in strangers because my mother has dementia and doesn't trust easily."

Google review · Home Instead, Phoenix · 5 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead&query_place_id=ChIJE-tYoJZrK4cRiYcOgcCrEcg

"I have lived by myself in my own house for years, and I didn't think I would care for having strangers come into my house and attend to me, do everything, private, washing, and so on."

Meta Ad Library · Angels There For You, client testimonial video running 215 days · transcript (faster-whisper) · https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?active_status=active&ad_type=all&country=US&q=%22in%20home%20care%22

"Additionally, they are pushing my personal boundaries in really surprising ways- criticism of me, my home, entering personal spaces that have nothing to do with my grandma, etc. I address it each time a boundary is crossed, but it's nearly every visit now"

r/CaregiverSupport · *Hired help feedback?* · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1szd4f4/hired_help_feedback/

"My mother moved into my house 5 months after I remarried. My children were in 6th grade and 1st grade. I was in my second year as a high school teacher teaching biology and human anatomy and physiology. My mom went on dialysis two weeks after arriving at my house. Unfortunately, my brand new husband was overwhelmed and withdrew the longer she lived with us. I know your exhaustion! I understand wanting it to be over. I understand the guilt over thinking you want it to be over."

Facebook · Family Caregivers Support Circle · comment · <https://www.facebook.com/groups/1581265219534379/posts/1800034654324100/>

Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites

Themes, measured

Each theme is one pattern over the whole corpus; the number is how many documents match it. The twenty most engaged voices on each theme, with replies, are in the Voices appendix under Tab 4.

Theme	Documents
'It's your duty' / 'it's your turn'	438
What the doctor, nurse and social worker say	250
'Take care of yourself'	143
What the parent says	95
'You're so strong' / 'I don't know how you do it'	93
'You should visit more often' / 'put her in a home'	50
'Let me know if you need anything' vs 'I'm coming Thursday at 3'	29

In her words

What the parent, the sibling, the spouse and the agency actually said to her. These are the lines she repeats to strangers online, quoted as she wrote them.

""You'll figure it out," she says. She won't even hear"

r/AgingParents · *My husband was floored when I told him how much healthcare REALLY costs* · 612 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1j6yu55/my_husband_was_floored_when_i_told_him_how_much/

"She said "don't forget, you will have to look after your siblings"."

r/AgingParents · *My mom informed me I will be inheriting the care of my two siblings* · 559 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1q839bu/my_mom_informed_me_i_will_be_inheriting_the_care/

"Dad has "joked" more than once than kids are his retirement."

r/AgingParents · *I may literally run away so I don't become my parent's caregiver* · 432 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/

"my mom "jokingly" said that she hopes I'm managing my money well so that she can afford to go into a nice home when she's older. She then told me that she and my father have no savings at all and no feasible plans for their old age."

r/AgingParents · *Am I evil? I don't want to care for my parents.* · 407 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vhdrk0/am_i_evil_i_dont_want_to_care_for_my_parents/

""I'll deal with it when I have to" really means "My loved ones will deal with it when I have to.""

r/AgingParents · 370 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1trt0u/im_urging_you_to_impress_upon_your_aging_parent/

"She'll just pull the "my heart" card to get him to back off."

r/AgingParents · *I am done. She's not my problem anymore. I quit.* · 189 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vj311a/i_am_done_shes_not_my_problem_anymore_i_quit/

"Stop taking her shopping. If she can go with a friend she should go with a friend. If she needs food she can get it delivered or you can bring her food. Also as others have said don't waste your life on her, she won't love you more for it."

r/AgingParents · *I fell for it again! Shopping with Mom.* · 94 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mchk2o/i_fell_for_it_again_shopping_with_mom/n5tw0hx/

"She said she would be fine alone in her house."

r/AgingParents · *offer rejected* · 75 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1fwww6z/offer_rejected/

"You are very lucky she said no to coming to live with you and your family. You cannot continue to prop up your mother by going to her house 2 or 3 times a day. She clearly needs more care and supervision and cannot continue to live in her home. You are going to have to let her live her life and fail at this before she is willing to make a change. That change should be in an AL if she can afford it or she will have to hire caregivers to come to her house x number of times a week, if she can afford it or she will need to go back into a facility if she cannot take care of herself. You cannot keep up the pace of running her household and your own. Yes the solutions sound harsh but when an elder refuses to compromise then unfortunately you have to choose your mom or yourself and your own health and emotional and physical well being."

r/AgingParents · *offer rejected* · 71 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1fwww6z/offer_rejected/lqilts/

"I buy a high seat with handles, his answer was get that out of here! He complained he was worried he'd fall in the shower. I bought a shower chair and a grab handle for the shower. He yelled, get that out!"

YouTube · *My elderly parent refuses help* · 70 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAlAo&lc=UgzQADKMy_8ZbuNsusl4AaABAg

"My mother, in memory care... Mom claimed I kidnapped her and calls all her neighbors that I have her stuck down here, while I change her husbands(dad's) diapers and cook three meals a day"

YouTube · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents* · 44 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugw7DVeYhTmdeZvSYWx4AaABAg

"She keeps saying that it's just because she "wasn't paying attention""

r/AgingParents · *Mom fell... again* · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1btImzi/mom_fell_again/

"she refuses any walk aids because "those are for old people.""

r/AgingParents · *Mom in early stages of dementia, refuses to bathe* · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vsmyza/mom_in_early_stages_of_dementia_refuses_to_bathe/

"She told me once she'd rather die than move."

YouTube · *My elderly parent refuses help* · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAlAo&lc=UgyD-NVourBhYocww0d4AaABAg>

"My mother has made it clear that she will not go to our homes. It really hurt !"

YouTube · *My elderly parent refuses help* · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAlAo&lc=Ugzw9OQWR5664nNDks14AaABAg>

"when I told mom that she said that burnout is not real and just an excuse to be lazy."

YouTube · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents* · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugzv_dffBgL_KA0TQyV4AaABAg

"I try to talk about me and she says it's all about me."

YouTube · *My elderly parent refuses help* · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAlAo&lc=UgwM_WpcCzoxWZOnbtX4AaABAg

"she tells people she wouldn't treat a dog the way she's being treated"

AgingCare · *A few years ago I promised my mother...* · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/a-few-years-ago-i-promised-my-mother-not-to-put-her-in-a-nursing-home-444573.htm>

"She refuses to let me and my two children move in, and she "forbids" him from moving out to be with us."

r/CaregiverSupport · *My (50F) BF (51M) is a full-time caregiver for his mom (85)* · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1so9pri/my_50f_bf_51m_is_a_fulltime_caregiver_for_his_mom/

"he cries he's lonely because he's driven the rest of our family away with being nasty and violent."

r/AgingParents · *can't take of/afford to take care of dad* · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1lcwa4w/cant_take_ofafford_to_take_care_of_dad/

"my mom (79) has a medical guardian necklace she never wears. says it's ugly and makes her feel like a patient."

r/AgingParents · *mom won't wear her medical alert* · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r9zd7l/mom_wont_wear_her_medical_alert_so_im_thinking/

"I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much--COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers"

r/CaregiverSupport · 95 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nobb2tw/

""Mama, you need to talk to your PCP or your oncologist, or I will.""

r/AgingParents · *I spent the day with my mom... I feel like the Geezer Whisperer* · 59 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1axokrw/i_spent_the_day_with_my_mom_trying_to_help_her/

"I replied by text "I don't want to be a fucking angel, I want my mom back." It got quiet after that."

r/CaregiverSupport · comment on *You're So Strong = You're On Your Own* · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/ns2641o/

"I dont need prayers, I badly need respite. A few hours of respite dosent really cut it for me. I need to sleep. I need to get away."

r/CaregiverSupport · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake_nocug1y/

"When people visit, including her own daughter and son in law, I constantly hear "I wouldn't want to live like this". Well I wouldn't either but what am I supposed to do?"

r/AgingParents · *I wouldn't want to live like this* · 502 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hti4b6/i_wouldnt_want_to_live_like_this/

""She should be at home with a caregiver and not in this fucking place! THERE I SAID IT". These were the exact words I read in a text sent to my mom"

r/dementia · 479 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/

"You're So Strong = You're On Your Own"

r/CaregiverSupport · *A Caregiver Translation Guide* · 423 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/

"She was very understanding and said she totally understood, then waited 10 months before inviting mom over. I was so proud of myself for asking for a specific, doable thing. That was the last time I asked anybody for anything."

r/CaregiverSupport · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nrxmsv9/

"I dont know how you do it Translation: Im glad its you and not me so Im not going to find out how to help."

r/CaregiverSupport · same thread · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/

"one of the nurses tried to argue, informing me "You're not a nurse.""

Google review · ALIYA on 87th, Chicago · 1 star · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=ALIYA%20on%2087th&query_place_id=ChIJCa-1o9wIDogRx7RKv8i1IK4

"They assured me it wasn't a problem, that if someone didn't show they'd send someone to fill in within hours. Less than 1 percent unfilled, they said. Fast forward to a month with them: they lied."

r/AgingParents · *Care agency* · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1c8uuxj/care_agency/

"When the kindly lady arrived at our door, she said, "I'm 77 years old and I'm recovering from back surgery. Now what do you want me to do?""

Caring.com · Visiting Angels Portland OR · 3 stars · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/oregon/portland/visiting-angels-portland-or>

"Their excuse is "she doesn't let me" but I have cameras and I know that they do not try."

r/CaregiverSupport · *Hired help feedback?* · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1szduf4/hired_help_feedback/

"They will tell you exactly what you want to hear but do not deliver."

Google review · Avir at Orem, Houston · 1 star · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Avir%20at%20Orem&query_place_id=ChIJJeQC8N-DrQIYRz-sdMRXG_jo

"They stopped coming this summer and we don't understand why. They are not dependable."

Caring.com · Visiting Angels Atlanta GA · 3 stars · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/georgia/atlanta/visiting-angels-atlanta-ga>

"You are not a bad daughter by getting some help with in-home care. I was burnt out trying to care for my mom who lives alone in Kentucky while raising my own family in Seattle. The distance was killing me."

Meta Ad Library · Home Instead UGC video, 73 days, proven tier · transcript (faster-whisper) · https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?active_status=active&ad_type=all&country=US&q=%22in%20home%20care%22

Tab 5 — Frustrations

Themes, measured

Each theme is one pattern over the whole corpus; the number is how many documents match it. The twenty most engaged voices on each theme, with replies, are in the Voices appendix under Tab 5.

Theme	Documents
The hospital discharge / rehab cycle	637
How to pay: Medicaid, VA, waivers, paperwork	609
Referral sites and calls that never stop	490
The parent refuses help / stubborn	469
Cost / can't afford / price per hour	295
The agency office: communication, billing	220
Aide no-show, cancel, turnover	170
Nobody warns you	69
The sugar-coating and the empty words	44
The rage, and the guilt about the rage	43
Their lack of planning	30

In her words

What makes her furious (reading; counts in the badges). Less the disease than the system around it: aides who do not show and an office that does not call back, a 4-hour minimum for a 1-hour need, \$30 to \$50 an hour of which the aide sees \$17, six agencies with six quotes and no way to compare, and a hospital that discharges on a Friday.

"It's expensive. Even with insurance you could be paying more than \$50 an hour for care. But something I want to make ABUNDANTLY CLEAR is the caregivers, the ones that come to your home and do the actual work, do not receive this money. You may pay so much an hour but the workers only get paid around \$17-18 an hour."

r/AgingParents · *I work in home health and I want to give you some inside secrets* · 765 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/

"75% of family caregivers receive NO respite care (AARP) Most insurance doesn't cover it Medicaid waiting lists are YEARS long Adult day programs barely exist Rural caregivers have zero options We burn out before we ever get approved"

r/CaregiverSupport · *Dear toxic positivity society: Shove your fake words and fix the respite care system* · 402 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/

"The hospital is trying to bully you into taking her. They want her out of their hair and make her your problem not theirs. Keep repeating to them that you cannot provide a "safe" environment and under no circumstances pick her up. Since she is on Medicaid it will be up to them to find a "safe" place to discharge her.... As long as you do not pick her up! So what if she gets charged \$2000 a day. Since she is on Medicaid, she has no resources to pay, you are not responsible for her bill and the hospital has to find a "safe" place for her."

r/AgingParents · Hospital trying to discharge demented mother in law who requires 24/hr care to wife and I. What do I do? · 134 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/113ykoe/hospital_trying_to_discharge_demented_mother_in_law/

"Take him back to the hospital. Tell them *Please read. I need help*. Do **not** agree to take him home. Give them his family's contact information. Ask to speak with the hospital's case manager, social worker, patient advocate, and, if necessary, the hospital administrator. Explain that he has no safe discharge plan because his sole caregiver is no longer able to provide care. Then WALK OUT. You have to care for..."

r/CaregiverSupport · Please read i need help · 125 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ulb1ow/please_read_i_need_help/ov3lv27/

"Under the Medicare rules, covered patients are given rights to challenge discharge decisions from a hospital or skilled nursing facility. You can do this by calling a company called Kepro"

r/AgingParents · How to challenge discharge of your parent from a hospital or skilled nursing facility · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/11fn0tb/how_to_challenge_discharge_of_your_parent_from_a_hospital/

"She needs to get in to skilled rehab. If she was only discharged from the hospital 10 days ago, and she has regular Medicare, you can get her placed at a swing bed facility for therapy at a nursing home, but you need to move quickly, you only have 20 more days to make that happen. Get in contact with the social worker that arranged the discharge from the hospital and see what assistance/referral they can offer. Also, when the aides shows up, walk out of the house. Even if all you do is sit outside and stare at the grass. Your mom is in no condition to "demand" anything from you, especially when you need to recharge."

r/AgingParents · Rant - Post Hospital Discharge · 81 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1dbgh7t/rant_post_hospital_discharge/l7qyaf1/

"I've left voice messages for several elder care agencies this morning to get advice on how to get help for my parents-no return calls yet."

YouTube · My elderly parent refuses help · 50 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAlAo&lc=UgyY_9Wty9qB6t6idJN4AaABAg

"But the whole *finding* process was a nightmare. We called six agencies, got wildly different quotes, had zero idea how to compare them, and the agency we ended up with took two weeks just to send us a contract. My mom was alone the entire time we were sorting it out. Now we pay \$38/hr, roughly \$600/week. We feel okay about it but honestly have no idea if that's the going rate or if we're getting a fair deal. We also have no backup plan for when our aide calls out sick which has already happened twice, and both times my sister had to drop everything."

r/AgingParents · What are you actually paying for your home care aide? Is it worth it? · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1rk3gby/what_are_you_actually_paying_for_your_home_care/

"For \$30-\$40 an hour for 12 hours, what the hell did I just get? I know this isn't the case for all hired caregivers but it seems to be the most common case. In a 12-hour period the only things that were completed: 1. unloading the dishwasher, 2. washing a sink full of dishes which many of them have to be redone"

r/CaregiverSupport · *Hired out a caregiver to help for a day, waste of money* · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/ymg4cy/hired_out_a_caregiver_to_help_for_a_day_waste_of/

"caregivers I hire for the few days I take off (at \$35/hour, 6-hour minimum). Am doing everything I can to try to maintain the relationships I have left but always feel like a prisoner on furlough when I leave the house."

r/CaregiverSupport · comment on *Can we normalize not wanting to be your parent's caregiver* · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ub81dl/can_we_normalize_not_wanting_to_be_your_parents/ot74w3d/

"Fast forward to a month with them: they lied. While one of the shifts has been covered consistently, the Friday-Sunday has not. It's either a no show"

r/AgingParents · *Care agency* · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1c8uuxj/care_agency/

"I don't like their mandatory three hours and the rate they charge per hour. The services are very minimal. They are just here for three hours and then they are gone and we go about our day."

Caring.com · Visiting Angels of Willamette Valley · 2 stars · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/oregon/albany/visiting-angels-of-willamette-valley-or>

"Where I live the minimum, for general ADL care is \$30/hour with a 4 hour minimum. For more medical or nursing care it is \$100-120/hour."

AgingCare · *How much does it cost hourly to hire an in-home care provider?* · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/how-much-does-it-cost-hourly-to-hire-an-in-home-care-provider-476899.htm>

"I'd fire the agency if it wasn't for 2 of the caregivers who are very dependable and good with my parents. The one works 5 to 7 shifts a week. I called the agency with today's no show and recommended they give some of their "office cut" to the dependable caregivers, because they are the only reason I stay with that agency. (I know that won't happen!)"

AgingCare · *Have you had problems with agency caregivers not showing for shifts?* · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/have-you-had-problems-with-agency-caregivers-not-showing-for-shifts-463572.htm>

"It's the agency's responsibility to send a fill-in to cover for a worker if they're going to be out. That's why they collect the big bucks and the caregiver gets minimum wage or just above. It's definitely a no-win situation for you."

AgingCare · same thread · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/have-you-had-problems-with-agency-caregivers-not-showing-for-shifts-463572.htm>

"Some caregivers call out and there is no backup. There were days we were without anybody."

Caring.com · Visiting Angels Atlanta GA · 4 stars · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/georgia/atlanta/visiting-angels-atlanta-ga>

"The caregivers call out on the weekends. We have to make sure we have someone here, and he is dependent on somebody being there."

Caring.com · Visiting Angels Atlanta GA · 4 stars · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/georgia/atlanta/visiting-angels-atlanta-ga>

"There was a caregiver that didn't show up and I'm still waiting for a call back from the office to know why. They haven't been very responsive."

Caring.com · Visiting Angels of Willamette Valley · 4 stars · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/oregon/albany/visiting-angels-of-willamette-valley-or>

"My MIL's hospice nurse & the home health aides never give an exact or approximate time of arrival, I'm wondering if this standard procedure? The aid comes 3 times a week and we were told it would be M-W-F 2 weeks ago but she came on Sunday this week"

AgingCare · *Should a health care agency call ahead of time to inform you about the aide who is coming?* · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/should-a-health-care-agency-call-a-head-of-time-to-inform-you-about-the-aide-who-is-coming-to-a-client-438076.htm>

"Another big issue for me was their inaccurate invoices. They consistently overbilled for time not worked. I learned that they don't bill based on the care giver's time sheet. They bill whatever they want and it's up to you to notify them"

Google review · At Your Side Home Care, Houston · 2 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=At%20Your%20Side%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJgWEGg6LdQIYRt9IKRAZ8H2M

"We have her room monitored so we were able to see that AtYourSideHomeCare's employees came stayed less than 10 minutes. They did not give our MIL a bath or complete any of the items we were charged for and they are continuing to charge us for even though we terminated their services."

Google review · At Your Side Home Care, Houston · 1 star · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=At%20Your%20Side%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJgWEGg6LdQIYRt9IKRAZ8H2M

"I began calling A Step Above about 11 am on June 15th being that the site showed an opening time of 9 am. I called several times with no answer... My application had been received 45 days ago so I wanted to know the status. Joey became very hostile"

Google review · A Step Above Case Management, Atlanta · 1 star · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=A%20Step%20Above%20Case%20Management&query_place_id=ChIJfebW018D9YgRdFFomitHtgI

"I've been without a caregiver for about a month now I put the order in about a month ago to switch agencies and now I have found an agency and they haven't turned in my paperwork yet no return phone calls no movement"

Google review · A Step Above Case Management, Atlanta · 1 star · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=A%20Step%20Above%20Case%20Management&query_place_id=ChIJfebW018D9YgRdFFomitHtgI

"The home health care agency that the VA selected for a personal care aide to come out to our home, I feel is not the best agency. We have had problems with the aides from day one. Some left to get a better job and others just come in late. The problem is I had to request to change aide because she was coming to my home 20 minutes late to care for my husband. The agency last week sent the same aide I got rid of before"

AgingCare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/should-a-health-care-agency-call-a-head-of-time-to-inform-you-about-the-aide-who-is-coming-to-a-clie-438076.htm>

"Tired of dealing with VA-approved "agencies" who provide the bottom of the barrel workers to care for my Dad. How to find someone professional and GOOD?"

r/eldercare · *In-Home Care Help - how to find someone that actually cares?* · https://www.reddit.com/r/eldercare/comments/1qcc8az/inhome_care_help_how_to_find_someone_that/

"I have always dealt with feeling like the hired caregiver just comes in, watches TV and does the bare minimum without trying to engage (except for one). I beg and plead with them to "care" for my husband, have a typewritten list that is minimal."

AgingCare · *I'm new at dealing with in-home care assistants, what are the expectations?* · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/im-new-at-dealing-with-in-home-care-assistants-what-are-the-expectations-496809.htm>

"Meals get made, laundry gets done, house looks fine. Then the aide leaves and mom sits with the TV on until I call."

r/CaregiverSupport · *Aide handles the house. Mom still stares at the wall all afternoon.* · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1vybtm5/aide_handles_the_house_mom_still_stares_at_the/

"He was discharged just yesterday—which I only learned about on Friday—so I spent the w[EEKEND]"

r/AgingParents · *The Saga Continues...* · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nv5e2p/the_saga_continues/

Tab 6 — Previous Solutions

Themes, measured

Each theme is one pattern over the whole corpus; the number is how many documents match it. The twenty most engaged voices on each theme, with replies, are in the Voices appendix under Tab 6.

Theme	Documents
Assisted living, memory care, hospice	1,987
Agencies and the rotating aides	940
The lawyer, the POA, the money	590
Medical alert buttons, devices, home fixes	569
Doing it all myself first	505
Care.com and the private hire	340
Adult day care and respite	237
Moved her in with us	169
Cameras	93

In her words

What she has already tried, and what it taught her. A sequence recurs across the threads (it is a reading of the quotes below, not a count): she does it herself, then buys a device (fall watch, camera, pill box), then tries a private hire from Care.com or a neighbor, then an agency, then the hospital forces the next step. Each rung has a failure mode she now recites from memory.

"I thought id would be bringing a meal over and taking them to appointments but the truth is its a living hell."

YouTube · 626 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzFmmIzwwUilqQ93KF4AaABAq

"I think you need to just hire a private aide for overnight to have the 1:1 care he needs during that time and leave him in the assisted living. I don't think you will get everything you need by having him in an apartment with an aide 24/7. What we found was that the assistant living will oversee the private aide and the private aide will oversee the assisted living and they will rat each other out to you. Win-win. If you don't like the assisted living, then I would just move him to a better one and get an aide overnight. I don't think bringing him to a private apartment is a good thing with everything he has going on. I think that might be a dangerous move and the assisted living is set up already with accessible bathrooms and showers and other fall risk measures. No place is perfect, but you will have to do a LOT to the apartment to make it work like an assisted living."

r/AgingParents · Has anyone ever moved their parent OUT of assisted living and instead got them 24/7 caregivers in a private residence? · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uwk1mi/has_anyone_ever_moved_their_parent_out_of/oxjpqez/

"I retired from my job of 36 years to care form my now 87 yr old dad. I loved my job and my friends and feels like I lost everything. I am constantly up and down and get 15,000 steps in just 5 rooms. He is sharp with his words and doesn't care how he treats people. My husband helps only for a few hours at night. By the time it is bedtime I am mentally drained and physically exhausted. I tried to bring in help, he was horrible to them."

YouTube · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive* · 75 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgzTQ7WDfZf_F3sOGeN4AaABAg

"Such a lifesaver when mom wasn't able to use her phone anymore. I could talk to her through it and she could see my face... I actually was with her on the camera when she passed as I was "dropping-in" regularly."

r/dementia · *Put a camera in their room if they are in a facility - best thing I did* · 138 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1qnu02i/put_a_camera_in_their_room_if_they_are_in_a/

"Got dad set up with bay alarm life alert after his stroke but he keeps "forgetting" to wear it or finds excuses to leave it on the counter. He'll wear it for a few days then stop for a week."

r/AgingParents · *Dad refuses to wear his medical alert consistently* · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1oe6jzc/dad_refuses_to_wear_his_medical_alert/

"my dad (82) same thing, his lives in a drawer. we're paying \$80/month for nothing."

r/AgingParents · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r9zd7l/mom_wont_wear_her_medical_alert_so_im_thinking/

"She refused to wear the one with a GPS in it, so we switched it out to a simpler one that is waterproof and just alerts to falls. She refuses to wear it."

r/dementia · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1djryf/refuses_to_wear_a_fall_alert_pendant_so_now_we/

"It worked. My 83 y.o. mother lives alone, 3,000 miles away. This evening I chatted with her just after her daytime helper left... Instead I got a phone call from an unfamiliar number and I took it; it was the Bay Alert people. She had fallen in the bathroom"

Amazon · Bay Alarm Medical SOS Micro · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2DD4JUVBZ370X>

"This may be fine for someone who has their full mental capacity, but for someone who does not understand why they may need a fall alert, it is worthless. The battery only charges for 36 hours which means that it has to be charged essentially every day."

Amazon · Bay Alarm Medical SOS Micro · 1 star · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R1TWDOR3JVFX5M>

"I made a decision to put a ring camera in her house because I'm worried about her safety as she lives 4 states away with no relatives nearby. In the two days since I've been gone, the camera has been shut off by her for over half the t[ime]"

r/AgingParents · *Ring Camera* · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/19a75ra/ring_camera/

"it has been suggested to me by a healthcare professional to monitor that carers are putting in their allocated time and arriving on time etc."

r/dementia · Cameras in the dementia home. Should I? · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/13xwvkq/cameras_in_the_dementia_home_should_i/

What she actually buys, in the corpus's own order (product ledger, D1 row 8). Counted as documents that name the thing; "with complaint" is the subset that also says it failed, was refused, or was wasted.

Product category (as the corpus names it)	Docs	With complaint	Top sources
medical alert / fall detection (pendant, watch, button)	477	85	trustpilot 428, reddit post 16, reddit comment 9
incontinence and hygiene (diapers, briefs, wipes, barrier cream)	260	40	youtube 109, reddit comment 58, reddit post 32
mobility (walker, wheelchair, cane, lift chair, hooyer, ramp, stair lift)	240	49	reddit comment 77, youtube 59, reddit post 32
nutrition and feeding (Ensure, thickener, meal delivery)	104	15	reddit comment 30, youtube 20, agingcare 18
camera (Ring, Wyze, nanny cam, baby monitor)	94	18	reddit post 28, reddit comment 18, agingcare 17
bathroom safety (grab bars, shower chair, raised toilet seat, commode)	56	11	reddit comment 14, amazon browser 14, youtube 10
bed and bedroom (hospital bed, rails, mattress, touch light)	39	10	reddit comment 15, amazon browser 10, reddit post 7
door / bed / chair alarms, locks, motion sensors, GPS	20	5	reddit comment 13, amazon browser 3, trustpilot 2
pill dispenser / pill organizer / med reminders	18	1	amazon browser 10, reddit comment 3, reddit post 2
phones and tech for the parent	16	2	reddit post 5, amazon browser 5, youtube 3
monitoring / check-in services	11	1	reddit comment 4, trustpilot 3, youtube 1

Her own phrasings when she names a product: "grab bars for easier up and down at the toilet"; "walker to bulldoze their way around and"; "camera in their house"; "walker to walk slowly"; "baby monitor so she can be in a separate room"; "door alarm for night"; "camera so if the homeless men come back"; "walker to take a look around"; "hospital bed for a month and when factoring in"; "walker to make it to the shower chair"; "hospital bed in the home at no cost"; "walker in the house"; "hospital bed in order to make it easier for he"; "walker for her to use around the house".

Amazon reviews of those products, read from the product pages (263 reviews across 30 products; low stars first, then five stars).

incontinence — 55 reviews

"Cannot manage big floppy size, small tabs and general shaplessness without help!. Maybe if you lay in bed & have a caretaker-but impossible to manage in a bathroom stall by yourself!"

Amazon · VIVO Organic Cotton Overnight Sensitive Skin Adult Incontinence · 1 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2DA7AVU19R4O8>

"Problems. These overnight pads are difficult to put on. Not comfortable. They are soft however."

Amazon · VIVO Organic Cotton Overnight Sensitive Skin Adult Incontinence · 2 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R20FY93WDFTO3K>

"Very bulky. The product is so bulky. Don't order if you want night protection. They have coverage around everything except around legs. And definitely you can't wear them under your clothes. They are very obvious and everyone can tell you are wearing them. They would be good for someone who is bedridden.

I unfortunately cannot return them since I opened the package and I don't know anyone who could use them. So make sure you ca"

Amazon · WhyWorry Adult Diapers with Tabs, Maximum Absorbency, Large, · 1 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R1YE44G521OQ2G>

"Really good. We've been through many store brands for our parent, and nothing has held up overnight due to the high diuretic dose. VIVO's are highly absorbent, love how soft the lining feels. Recommend Strongly"

Amazon · VIVO Organic Cotton Overnight Sensitive Skin Adult Incontinence · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2TWM6M7WWBME5>

"Best adult diapers we have used. I really liked its plush lining made with organic cotton. We have been buying diapers for several years and have never seen such softness. Fit was very good with the readjustable velcro tabs. Absorbency and leakage control were excellent - lasted both parents all night without any side leakage issues at all. We were previously using a booster pad inside a regular absorbency diaper - now no longer needed. I would say "

Amazon · VIVO Organic Cotton Overnight Sensitive Skin Adult Incontinence · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/RPJ5CIPKARV8L>

mobility — 39 reviews

"Great walker but very creaky. Another Update: I have now owned 3 of these bad boys. And they just keep getting worse somehow. the first one I reviewed below. The second one I had for a few months with no issue and then all of a sudden something started happening with the wheels where one would stop rotating and I couldn't steer straight, it would veer to one side or the other. I tried taking all the wheels off and cleaning them all out, assuming "

Amazon · Walk Mate 3 Wheel Rollator Walker with Seat for Slim Seniors · 1 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/RTIMKFFMZB17D>

"Dissatisfied with safety of this product.. I am happy with using the roller to walk. But I am very unhappy with trying to use the seat to sit on. The brakes are not compatible to use as a seat. The brakes do not hold to use as a seat. It is very dangerous to sit down in because it will continue to move out from under you. If the brakes would hold it would be perfect. I pacifically bought it to use at grandchildren's ball games to walk and sit. And it is curre"

Amazon · Walk Mate 3 Wheel Rollator Walker with Seat for Slim Seniors · 3 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R1EALY7SIAKIE>

"NOT BALANCED WELL. ☆☆☆ USE AT YOUR OWN RISK!☆☆☆ . Unfortunately, I can't rate the product as zero!

We purchased this walker for my mother to use in her apartment. It was used for 3 days when the walker tipped over and ripped her leg open. The massive wound required 25 stitches, she developed an infection and required skin grafting surgery and six months of nursing care to change the dressings and many ER and plastic surgeon visits before the wound was sufficiently "

Amazon · Walk Mate 3 Wheel Rollator Walker with Seat for Slim Seniors · 1 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/RW0XF208B8FW3>

"It's great!. I love this walker. It was easy to assemble right out of the box, with a helpful instruction booklet.

It looks good, rolls smoothly, and wheels are perfect size for going most places. Lightweight, easy to fold and unfold for transport. Not good for those with super-poor balance, but is a great walking and standing assist for most walking support. It's 3 wheels (not 4), so care should be taken when walking and sitti"

Amazon · Walk Mate 3 Wheel Rollator Walker with Seat for Slim Seniors · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R3FU9HKIV8N7KB>

"Exactly what I was looking for. Purchased this for my girlfriend to use since she broke a bone in her left hip I needed one she could set down on and this fit the bill I would not recommend this walker for a larg person, my girlfriend is small less than 90 pounds so it works great for her, overall its a pretty heavy duty little walker that works for its intended use

Shopping was fairly quick as it was delivered 3 days earlier than expected, pretty"

Amazon · Walk Mate 3 Wheel Rollator Walker with Seat for Slim Seniors · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R3ECXWUR29WHB5>

bathroom safety — 37 reviews

"It works, looks good, but the anchors are just rubbish.. This grab handle works, and the installation would be pretty simple if not for the anchors provided. The photo with the translucent anchor shows what ships with the product. It's a terrible, unreliable, anchor that fell apart when installed as instructed. I happen to have some quality anchors as shown in green, which, after removing their junk, I used to secure the handle to my complete satisfaction. So, if you own o"

Amazon · Grab Bars for Shower 2 Pack, Stainless Steel Bathroom Grab B · 3 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R27BGVBN41FMD6>

"Seat broke. Have had this for maybe 3 days I sat on the seat and it broke. I definitely dont weigh 40lbs so why did it break very disappointed"

Amazon · Raised Toilet Seat with Handles 400lb - Adjustable 3 in 1 Co · 1 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R1NLLC5Z56BODQ>

"Didn't last and came with defective screw hole. First, one of the main support screw holes was filled with hard plastic upon arrival. We had to heat up the screw in order to melt the plastic in the hole in order to get this assembled. We've had this just over 2-months, the user is 250 lbs and it's broken. My Godmother is on a limited income and can't afford to replace this. Disgusted.

Also, the picture shows you can use the back with the toilet's original seat on"

Amazon · Raised Toilet Seat with Handles 400lb - Adjustable 3 in 1 Co · 1 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/RDRRGJAJ8ZR7R>

"Highly recommend. Got to the point with balance issues that I need grab bars to feel safe while showering. After sorting through the bazillion options, I chose these for price, appearance, hand grips, and included mounting hardware. I am very happy with the result and highly recommend them."

Amazon · 2 Pack Grab Bars for Showers 16 Inch Anti Slip · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/RRJEMZNPEV6QA>

"Very good, but.... Recommend with these issues. Installing vertically on a tile wall it was very hard to keep it in position to mark the holes for drilling. In the end I drilled the upper most hole first, put the plastic insert in and then screwed it down. I taped the bottom to the tile in position so it couldn't move. I had two markers, a thin and a thicker one. Neither would fit in the holes far enough to mark the tile. I found a mec"

Amazon · 2 Pack Grab Bars for Showers 16 Inch Anti Slip · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R30O1BHH3V72I4>

medical alert — 33 reviews

"Wouldn't hold charge or connection. Notifications come only by email.. Equipment didn't work: wouldn't hold a charge and notifications for low battery were sent by email instead of a text. They say it works off AT&T and Verizon towers, but no matter where I placed the base, it wouldn't stay connected. I was getting multiple emails each day about low battery and no connection. I ordered a second one directly from the company, guess what...same problems. And because I was patient in working"

Amazon · Bay Alarm Medical SOS Mobile GPS - 24/7 Medical Alert with O · 1 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R31UPMLPF6942F>

"Worked well...to start with. Although I had been pleased with the unit to start with, I found that it had stopped working suddenly. I tried to check functionality on my cell phone but recorded message stated that the cell signal was not available. My computer measured a download speed of 200 Mgps, so that was silly. Our phones were working. I reset the password and reinstalled the app on my phone. Restarted the phone. Nothing. I finally got a re"

Amazon · Bay Alarm Medical SOS Mobile GPS - 24/7 Medical Alert with O · 3 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2V0O8PFEE2L7F>

"I WOULDN'T RECCOMEND THIS ITEM. I got this for my wife who has dementia, it was an easy set-up, but it always showed my wife being in another house, when she was here...It never depicted her at home, they also make a BIG DEAL, about the service agreement being a CONTRACT, so if it didn't work satisfactory you wouldn't be able to cancel it...BAD BUSINESS!"

Amazon · SecuLife GPS Tracker for Elderly with Fall Detection – Medic · 1 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R3FMVYCC7UMW5E>

"Simple, Reliable and affordable.. I looked at several of these systems and I like that there were no salesman involved. I could make the decision based on the information that was provided.

The purchase process was simple the registration Was also simple and three months in, the response time the ease of use for my elderly mother and the comfort it provides her family is unbeatable.

Would highly recommend this product without reservation. Those of "

Amazon · Bay Alarm Medical SOS Mobile GPS - 24/7 Medical Alert with O · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2NFWP7ATRLZV2>

"If you are getting older and live alone, this is something you should seriously consider obtaining.. I didn't like buying this, but after two "semi-controlled excursion to prone', and the inability to get up on my own where it took way too long to get to my phone, I decided I needed to get something like this. I'm 70 so I guess it was inevitable. It comes with a substantial belt clip and a neck lanyard. It is well built, and I find myself being able to ignore it hanging around my neck.

While getting used to wearing"

Amazon · Bay Alarm Medical SOS Mobile GPS - 24/7 Medical Alert with O · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R1ILUYN8ZZNCX0>

bed — 31 reviews

"Did my homework. The directions were unclear with the last two parts. My husband really likes, I'm glad

Gave it a score of three based on the direction not clear, and misleading"

Amazon · HOMEAL Bed Rails for Elderly Adults Safety - Adjustable Bed · 3 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/RF386ES7M14PS>

"Ok, but.... Rail is ok. It's compliant because it doesn't create a space between the bed and rail that could be dangerous, which was a concern with recently recalled bedrails. However, while the rail is functional and serves its purpose, I reduced the rating because even when its tightly secured it still has a little movement. I expected it to be more tight without any 'shakiness' for lack of a better word. Similar to a stairway"

Amazon · Bed Rails for Elderly Adults Safety, Stainless Steel Bed Ass · 3 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2XDWJF889AO47>

"Not what I'd hoped. One shade came dented, and they're a bit smaller than I wanted. I wouldn't buy them again but they're fine for a room you don't use much."

Amazon · 21" Touch Bedside lamps with 2 USB & AC Outlets, 3-Way Dimma · 3 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R1TU9QLU071NG4>

"Secure assistance rail. This bed rail is an essential tool for assisting someone with limited mobility with getting out of bed. It is sturdy and feels secure so I have dependable leverage to get up. The frame has adjustable leg height to suit any height of bed. I like the large foot size, it genuinely feels designed to be strong. The railing height can be adjusted if needed. It was pretty easy to put together, most of the components snap fi"

Amazon · HOMEAL Bed Rails for Elderly Adults Safety - Adjustable Bed · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2URXHVHVPK5OP>

"Sturdy and well built elderly adults bed rails!. This is a very good set of elderly adults bed rails. I tried on our master bed and it is what exactly I was looking for.

My 2 cents below :

Pros:

- Fits well on a king-sized bed and it is supposed to fit any other size bed
- Great for the safety of elderly adults
- These are thick and semi-soft edge bumpers that will provide safety with confidence
- Height and width adjustable mechanism is nice to have. Conveni"

Amazon · HOMEAL Bed Rails for Elderly Adults Safety - Adjustable Bed · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2MK4K7JI550VP>

alarms — 29 reviews

"Inconvenience. Needs to be paired again and again once switched off and then turned on. Inconvenient"

Amazon · Upgraded Version Bed Sensor Alarm and Fall Prevention for El · 2 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R3INMYMTXHSLD>

"Very poorly made product. Very cheap product. Would not even power on after inserting batteries. Accompanying literature makes it clear that this is a cheap Chinese product."

Amazon · Smart Caregiver Bed Alarm for Elderly Adults, Alerts You Whe · 1 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2F72IVU8UZ8MJ>

"Works, but be careful of one quirk. Giving this just 3 stars because of two issues I've had. First, the I ordered the pad pictured here — 10"x30" — but it didn't work with my Mom: The alarm kept going off at the slightest movement. I called the company, and the owner (?) himself took my call and explained the problem. Because my Mom weighs less than 115 pounds, I needed the larger sensor pad. He graciously overnighted me the larger version, which worke"

Amazon · Smart Caregiver Bed Alarm for Elderly Adults, Alerts You Whe · 3 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2ICSXG74HY9B>

"Great for caregivers of elderly parents. I purchased this for when my 90+ year old father who came to stay with me. He has previously fallen out of bed when going to the bathroom and bought this in hopes that it would let me know when he is about to get out of bed. It works wonderfully. When my father starts to swing his leg over his bed the sensor picks it up and the monitor that I have near me will sound. I am able to go to his room before he gets himself"

Amazon · Upgraded Version Bed Sensor Alarm and Fall Prevention for El · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/RBW12XUN50OOY>

"Reliable, affordable safety for loved ones. This is a great little device at an affordable price!! Setup was very straightforward. I was able to place the sensor under my mother's bed and did a number of test runs at different angles to find the sweet spot to place it. It works like a charm and alerts as soon as she swings her legs over so that I have time to get in and help her up to the restroom. This is a game changer for fall prevention and for people with"

Amazon · Upgraded Version Bed Sensor Alarm and Fall Prevention for El · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R30AYGZLF9SSV6>

pill dispenser — 25 reviews

"Not user friendly. One of the worst products I've purchased. The lid does not open wide but stays at an angle and slams shut. Trying to open wide as shown in startup guide will break it. the turn table is hard to take out because of this. The Alarm is way to quiet, the locking mechanism is cheap plastic as are the keys. They send you 3 cheap plastic keys that are a very bizarre shape. It does have a little place to keep one of them on "

Amazon · Windtrace Automatic Pill Dispenser for Elderly with Alarm · 1 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R1KWEMWBAQJV2R>

"Alarm is helpful. The paper dial in the middle has to be taped in place as it slips. It can be tricky to get all the pills out as some may stick and you need to be abler to get your finger in to pop them out. Need to pay attention when loading-hard to get extra pill out if your fingers are at all large or if dexterity is not good. We dump into a cup as it is a bit cumbersome to flip the whole thing. It's a good next step and you can s"

Amazon · Windtrace Automatic Pill Dispenser for Elderly with Alarm · 3 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/RVH7GOV66X4B3>

"No Four Compartments. Super disappointed to receive this with only 3 pill compartments for each day instead of the four as depicted in photos and description. I need there to be four compartments. Very disappointing."

Amazon · Windtrace Automatic Pill Dispenser for Elderly with Alarm · 1 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2DA59UPGQRY9E>

"Very good pill dispenser. This dispenser is working great for my elderly mother with dementia. This has been a good purchase and I recommend it to anyone with similar requirements."

It holds 2 weeks of her AM & PM pills. The contents and controls are secure under the clear locked lid, so she can't mess anything up. It reminds her to take her pills on time, and it prevents her from taking extra doses, which used to happen regularly because she"

Amazon · Windtrace Automatic Pill Dispenser for Elderly with Alarm · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R5E3829V53RX7>

"Best thing on the market. Well made perfect for what we needed. No more accidental dosing and easy to set up. They can only get the doses needed at that time. They can't take the next day by accident or because they didn't think they took it. Best product on the market in my opinion!"

Amazon · Windtrace Automatic Pill Dispenser for Elderly with Alarm · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2J11O5B0C2QGL>

nutrition — 14 reviews

"Don't buy. As other reviewers have noted, the dropper doesn't work. And without a dropper, the product is useless."

UPDATE: The seller was kind enough to contact me and offer a refund once they saw my review. As nice as that was, I'm afraid I can't change my rating or original comment since their kindness does not fix the issue with a poorly designed dropper."

Amazon · Appetite Stimulant for Dogs - Vitamin B12 (Methylcobalamin) · 1 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/ROCUCKHDNL865>

"My dog would throw up after putting this in her mouth Wouldn't buy it again. I noticed a difference in my dog eating, but she would throw up after putting stuff in her mouth"

Amazon · Appetite Stimulant for Dogs - Vitamin B12 (Methylcobalamin) · 3 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2C9QDXL0XQN1H>

"Improved My Life. First, I'm not paid or sponsored. I just wanted to give MY opinion and experience. I've been using this since February 2026. After 3 days I noticed some small positive changes. My hair became less brittle. Also, my energy became more steady. My skin does feel a bit more bouncy as well. Mostly though, when I take this collagen I feel sturdier. I have small injuries often from abnormally stretchy ligaments and a lot of"

Amazon · Premium Liquid Collagen for Women Weight Loss & Beauty w. Hy · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2HM0K2G2799AW>

"I crave it and not food. I love this stuff. The taste is light and subtle. Has light peach taste. Definitely helped skin. Even hair and nails got better. And helps crave hunger. I noticed I didnt want to snack during the day and barely wanted food all together. But Definitely eat. Lol. I lost 5lbs. In 3 weeks. Could have been more if I didnt make bad food choices when I did make myself eat. Lol. I have tried many glp1 items. Im not over weig"

Amazon · Premium Liquid Collagen for Women Weight Loss & Beauty w. Hy · 5 stars · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R27KXJ6KX8160B>

"I have hired help from Care.com to help with my mother's bed bath. The people are ok. They get burnt out and I have to replace them after a while."

r/CaregiverSupport · *Hiring Help Causing Anxiety?* · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1fntqww/hiring_help_causing_anxiety/

"you'll need at least four people to cover a full schedule: two for the regular shifts and two to cover days off. You'll need one for days and one for nights, since no one is going to work seven days a week."

r/AgingParents · comment by a home health worker · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/niuwzk8/

"Today is my FIRST DAY with a person coming in. We're paying \$30/hr to an agency I considered care.com but for \$5/hr more i don't have to interview anyone or any of that legwork I'm nervous. I'm imagining this is similar to what parents feel on the first night away from the baby?"

r/dementia · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/ok_uadt/

"I've posted a couple ads on care.com in the past couple years, but the responses I get are overwhelming, disorganized, and a lot to process. My partner and I both work busy jobs and it's difficult to set aside hours per day for a week at a time to meet people and respond to messages"

r/dementia · *Finding in-home care for mom* · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1bvecp3/finding_inhome_care_for_mom/

"I am not ready to consider just yet hiring people off care.com or similar. We tried that and found that people wanted to be paid in cash or unreliable."

r/AgingParents · Care agency · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1c8uuxj/care_agency/

"Beware.....if you cancel a subscription they will still charge you. I cancelled 2 years ago and suddenly they decided to start charging me again.....I'm out 155.00."

Facebook · comment on Care.com's page · https://www.facebook.com/caredotcom/posts/pfbid04LhPBUXCQ17moqTjqYcYLUcSu7dEJj64iFT9v3q7wyb9HHmeKMGW54QXsUYUfywxl?comment_id=898024503135189

"Pros of Private hire: - hourly rate more affordable (if you do the bookkeeping and tax reporting yourself) - may be easier to find someone for only 10 hrs a week... Pros of Agency hire: - aids are vetted with background checks - the agency provides subs when your person is sick or on vacation - no bookkeeping or tax reporting"

AgingCare · Hiring private caregiver · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/hiring-private-caregiver-looking-for-clarification-on-financial-matter-490856.htm>

"When my Dad needed someone to help him, he hired 3-shifts of caregivers through an Agency, the caregivers were already vetted and experienced... And if one could not make their shift, the Agency quickly found someone else to fill that shift. The Agency did all the payroll work, plus the Agency was licensed, bonded and insured. Yes, it was expensive doing this, but well worth the cost."

AgingCare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/im-looking-to-hire-an-independent-live-in-caregiver-non-agency-any-suggestions-479831.htm>

"My mom was private pay & the 1st agency was TERRIBLE! We had to fire them. If private pay, find a new company or run ads (require background checks, drug screens, references). Put the word out among churches, relatives, etc. Maybe even check local nursing schools."

AgingCare · How do I get peace of mind when caregivers never show up? · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/how-do-i-get-peace-of-mind-when-care-givers-home-health-aid-never-shows-up-445660.htm>

"I'm not hiring private caregivers. I'm hiring an agency: I don't need to think about insurance, etc. Yes, we need several people rotating. Yes, no-show would be terrible. The agency says they'll show up. I hope they're being honest."

AgingCare · Does anyone have a good experience with 24-hour in-home care through an agency? · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/does-anyone-have-a-good-experience-with-24-hour-in-home-care-through-an-agency-482758.htm>

"Caring for your mom or dad after surgery or illness? The PACE program might help you get paid while keeping them at home"

TikTok · @momhelpmnm · 819 comments, 299K plays · <https://www.tiktok.com/@momhelpmnm/video/7533277137395010846>

"They are stalkers. They will call and email you nonstop for YEARS. My dad was 92 when I contacted them many years ago... My dad died at 100. And yes we found a great place on our own. But even though he died already, I'm STILL getting harassing phone calls from fresh numbers"

r/AgingParents · *Never use "A Place for Mom"* · 584 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1kocgug/never_use_a_place_for_mom/

"Just a disclaimer that after giving A Place for Mom my info to try to find a place for mom who is on Medicaid only, they cannot help. They only deal in private pay."

r/AgingParents · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1icxwp0/a_place_for_mom_is_a_waste_of_time_if_on_medicaid/

"The single most useful thing I learned, and the thing I see almost nobody mention in threads here, is the Area Agency on Aging. Every region in the US has one. Federally funded, locally run. They coordinate respite care, adult day programs, meal delivery, transportation, in-home support, and often have small emergency funds that don't get advertised anywhere."

r/AgingParents · *PSA: call your Area Agency on Aging before you think you need to* · 63 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t2bz8x/psa_for_anyone_navigating_aid_for_an_aging_parent/

"We chose PACE because the Adult Day Care provides doctor, nursing, physical therapy, & occupational therapy ON-SITE. What a relief it is to have PACE pick my mother on weekdays and care for her from 9a-3p, shower, exercise, schedule appointments, take her to and from appointments, & keep her entertained."

AgingCare · *What do you wish you knew about caregiving before your parent got sick?* · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/what-do-you-wish-you-knew-about-caregiving-before-your-parent-got-sick-485033.htm>

The facility (what happens when home care fails)

"I do not recommended anyone sending their loved one here. They will tell you exactly what you want to hear but do not deliver. My mom caught COVID in Dec. and was in the hospital they transferred her to a long term facility and then she was sent here. A week after being at Capstone she went from good to bad."

Google review · Avir at Orem, Houston · 1 star · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Avir%20at%20Orem&query_place_id=ChIJJeQC8N-DrQIYRz-sdMRXG_jo

"During her stay, she was frequently left sitting in her own urine and feces for long periods of time. Basic care like cleaning, repositioning, and feeding was not consistently provided. I often had to step in after work just to make sure she was cleaned and fed"

Google review · Elevate Care Windsor Park, Chicago · 1 star · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Elevate%20Care%20Windsor%20Park&query_place_id=ChIJPTYpqEaoDogR6_hjGdDQnHc

Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites

Themes, measured

Each theme is one pattern over the whole corpus; the number is how many documents match it. The twenty most engaged voices on each theme, with replies, are in the Voices appendix under Tab 7.

Theme	Documents
What helped: this sub, these videos, people who get it	568
The best decision we ever made	500
They came the same day / at a moment's notice	388
Finally, peace of mind and sleep	231
What worked with the parent	118
The office answered and kept me informed	81
A named person who became family	61

In her words

How she talks when it worked. Measured across 885 five-star Google and Caring.com reviews: 359 (41%) name a specific person (Kenya, Linh, Chichi, Brian, Jhon, Pam); 33 say "peace of mind"; 20 say "like family"; 49 (6%) praise speed (same day, right away, at a moment's notice); 39 (4%) praise the office or scheduler answering. The person is what she praises; speed and the office are the next two, at a distance.

"After we finally convinc[ed her]... I have to brag because I'm so freaking happy"

r/AgingParents · 830 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w3g2fn/i_have_to_brag_because_im_so_freaking_happy/

"For the night at least, I can finally breathe."

r/AgingParents · *Day 3, my prayers were heard* · 225 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nlfyw/day_3_my_prayers_were_heard/

"My husband's PACE program found me three days of respite so I could recover. His homecare nurse even dropped off cough syrup for me."

r/CaregiverSupport · *Caregiver burnout and respite care* · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1bahk0o/caregiver_burnout_and_respite_care/

"The very day I called, someone came to my parents' house to talk with me about our needs and to explain costs and processes. The staff coordinated a caregiver for that same evening who was wonderful and made all of my concerns about bringing in a stranger insta[ntly disappear]"

Google review · Home Instead, Phoenix · 5 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead&query_place_id=ChIJE-tYoJZrK4cRiYcOgcCrEcg

"My father needed assistance at home following his release from the hospital, and I was clueless as to where to begin. The hospital case worker recommended Home Instead, and I could not have been more pleased"

Google review · Home Instead West and Southwest Houston · 5 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20instead%20-%20West%20and%20Southwest%20Houston&query_place_id=ChIJE92yB9vcQIYRRpNA8t5-1_0

"My dads caregiver, has become like family, My parents truly love her. When I know she is there with them, I am so very at peace, knowing they are in the best hands. I cant recommend them enough. The management, and the scheduling people are fantastic."

Google review · Home Instead West and Southwest Houston · 5 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20instead%20-%20West%20and%20Southwest%20Houston&query_place_id=ChIJE92yB9vcQIYRRpNA8t5-1_0

"The second employee I want to acknowledge is Kenya who's my mom's caregiver. My mom is not the easiest person to deal with at age 98 and Kenya has been wonderful with her. My mom actually enjoys her coming"

Google review · Home Instead, Phoenix · 5 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead&query_place_id=ChIJE-tYoJZrK4cRiYcOgcCrEcq

"Even when we reached out at 3 AM, she responded immediately and showed up without hesitation."

Google review · FirstLight Home Care of Houston Metro · 5 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=FirstLight%20Home%20Care%20of%20Houston%20Metro&query_place_id=ChIJ-Z2BFGTBQIYRiuJo_ZTci44

"The caregiver they provided to us, Jhon, is amazing. He is very nice, reliable, and, energetic. He is willing to do anything that we ask him to do. FirstLight Home Care has given me a peace of mind knowing that my husband is in a good hands."

Google review · FirstLight Home Care of Houston Metro · 5 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=FirstLight%20Home%20Care%20of%20Houston%20Metro&query_place_id=ChIJ-Z2BFGTBQIYRiuJo_ZTci44

"I was discharged from rehab after suffering a stroke and used FirstLight Home Care – Houston Metro for five weeks during my recovery. I truly don't know how I would have made it through this difficult time without their support."

Google review · FirstLight Home Care of Houston Metro · 5 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=FirstLight%20Home%20Care%20of%20Houston%20Metro&query_place_id=ChIJ-Z2BFGTBQIYRiuJo_ZTci44

"This company could also could adapt right away if we were not around and needed more hours of care at any given time. Several times we needed immediate help that they were able to provide quickly."

Google review · At Your Side Home Care, Houston · 5 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=At%20Your%20Side%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJgWEGg6LdQIYRt9IKRAZ8H2M

"They have helped me with my husband when it got to a point where I could not do it all and needed someone to help me so that I could run errands etc. and just needed some time with friends."

Google review · At Your Side Home Care, Houston · 5 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=At%20Your%20Side%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJgWEGg6LdQIYRt9IKRAZ8H2M

"We were out of town and they took excellent care of my disabled mother at a MOMENT'S notice!"

Google review · TheKey Senior Home Care, Phoenix · 5 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=TheKey%20-%20Senior%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJcZb1mzilK4cRbfvT3_8kk

"Home Instead never made me feel like I was creating problems for them or imposing on them when I would request a different caregiver —they just fixed the staffing situation."

Caring.com · Home Instead West and Southwest Houston · 4 stars · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/texas/houston/home-instead-west-and-southwest-houston>

"They are flexible in working with changes in scheduling. I found the caregivers to be compassionate people who took an interest in my father's well being as well as assisting him with things he could not do for himself."

Caring.com · Home Instead West and Southwest Houston · 4 stars · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/texas/houston/home-instead-west-and-southwest-houston>

"They match personalities with the person."

Caring.com · Visiting Angels of Willamette Valley · 4 stars · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/oregon/albany/visiting-angels-of-willamette-valley-or>

"She comes in and makes it possible for me to leave. It is more expensive than independent caregivers but I feel like I can afford it."

Caring.com · Visiting Angels of Willamette Valley · 4 stars · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/oregon/albany/visiting-angels-of-willamette-valley-or>

"Right at Home went above and beyond to find a caregiver to fill short term needs for me and my family in Atlanta. So grateful to have found this kind and excellent team!"

Google review · Right at Home, Atlanta · 5 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Right%20at%20Home&query_place_id=ChIJJbD8tQwD9YgRHskYAJ4S2JM

"They provide a service that makes my parents lives better and my life easier. I've been impressed with how they've been able to adapt to changing schedules and needs. Their follow-up and communication is impressive."

Caring.com · Right at Home Greater Atlanta · 4 stars · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/georgia/atlanta/right-at-home-greater-atlanta>

"And the first time Pam and I met up, we just clicked. We just worked things out together so nicely that, yeah, we're buddy buddies now."

Meta Ad Library · Angels There For You client video, 215 days running · transcript · https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?active_status=active&ad_type=all&country=US&q=%22in%20home%20care%22

"Their care pros not only helped my mom with doctor's appointments, they gave her real companionship that she needed when I couldn't be there myself. So if you're struggling, please know you don't have to do this alone."

Meta Ad Library · Home Instead UGC video · transcript · https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?active_status=active&ad_type=all&country=US&q=%22in%20home%20care%22

"Greg and his team have been providing care for my husband for almost three years... we have had 1 or 2 hours of care every day and 24/7 overnight care when I need to be out of town for work. Jessica manages the scheduling and I love the easy way I can email her ahead of time with any additional hours needed."

Google review · Home Instead Houston, Bellaire, Missouri City · 5 stars · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead%20-%20Houston%2C%20Bellaire%2C%20Missouri%20City%20%26%20Sugar%20Land&query_place_id=ChIJ0ek3qo_CQIYRE4ql0bpX_ns

Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes

Themes, measured

Each theme is one pattern over the whole corpus; the number is how many documents match it. The twenty most engaged voices on each theme, with replies, are in the Voices appendix under Tab 8.

Theme	Documents
I don't want to be my mom's caretaker / do this anymore	539
I want to sleep through the night	476
Not to be a burden to my kids / to go on my own terms	386
A nurse for 12 hours straight, hours that fit, no minimum	250
I want my life back	136
Someone to say 'I'm coming Thursday at 3pm'	107
For her to stay home safely / accept help	97
A way to pay for it that doesn't bankrupt us	85
To be heard: 'I just want to hear from people who've been here'	19

In her words

What she would buy if it existed (reading of the quotes below). Sleep. A name she can text at 3am. The same person on Tuesday as on Monday. Someone who shows up the day after discharge. Permission to be a daughter again.

"I had to start setting boundaries. That has helped a lot."

YouTube · 73 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=Ugzt_xnJkq_89zsfRC94AaABAg

"I'd go. What they don't tell you about dying is that it often drags on like this. The movies make it seem like its a few days and everyone jumps on a plane for the last moments. The reality is that for a lot of people it goes on for months or years. At first you think its imminent so you take off work, cancel vacations, maybe even put off your own medical appointments because you want to be available. But eventually you have to go back to work, take care of yourself, enjoy your own life. He is going to die and not going on your vacation will not change that. I'd go."

r/AgingParents · *Should we cancel a family trip because our dad is dying?* · 67 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tp9u65/should_we_cancel_a_family_trip_because_our_dad_is/oo77pcc/

"I'm tired, frustrated, my blood pressure is up. Feel like ending my own life! Just want some peace. I want to be left alone!"

YouTube · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent* · 58 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=Ugzx9D5EVnMou-71Azi4AaABAg>

"I'm a caregiver to my mom and I don't want to be. I don't want to find balance or strength or be grateful, I just want to stop period."

YouTube · *How to Manage Compassion Fatigue in Caregiving* · 46 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7keppA8XRas&lc=Ugxt_hG2EF0a_GcuKZl4AaABAg

"Some caregivers need help with literally everything, and some caregivers need VERY specific types of help. Showing up with groceries she can't or won't eat is a waste."

r/CaregiverSupport · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nryb2sr/

"Just about to put my spouse in Long term care, believe me I feel your pain. The decision finally arrived when I realized that truthfully she's killing me. No sleep, constant care 7 by 24 the situation is just unbearable and no one alone can do this long term. Hang in there the best you can then get the help that you need. ALZ just completely sucks"

r/Alzheimers · *May have reached the end at home care, as many before (REALLY LONG)* · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Alzheimers/comments/1rh3ff3/may_have_reached_the_end_at_home_care_as_many/o7vuod4/

"Here's a word: "Tuesday." Tell them a day. "Come Tuesday from 2 to 6.""

r/AgingParents · comment · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/okbo10x/

"Is there really no way to get a little home care on Medicare except for medical needs like blood pressure checks or PT/OT? Nothing for help with putting together meals and making sure the person takes their meds? I have to work full time, but my dad can't remember to take his medication on his own"

r/dementia · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/okujoqs/

"I need a night sitter (6 hours for 1 to 2 nights) so that I can sleep... I work 11 hours a day, very demanding job and sleep is essential for me in order to survive. How much are the costs of such a sitter? Where could I find one?"

AgingCare · *Night sitters* · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/night-sitters-any-advice-on-salary-and-where-to-look-or-care-478639.htm>

"I've had 2 different caregivers and I would prefer to have a single one."

Caring.com · Visiting Angels of Willamette Valley · 4 stars · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/oregon/albany/visiting-angels-of-willamette-valley-or>

"I expect the caregivers to show up as scheduled and if one doesn't show up, I expect someone to show up within a hour of the scheduled time."

Caring.com · Visiting Angels Appleton · 3 stars · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/wisconsin/appleton/visiting-angels-appleton>

"I would like to have more feedback about how my loved one is doing."

Caring.com · Visiting Angels of Willamette Valley · 4 stars · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/oregon/albany/visiting-angels-of-willamette-valley-or>

"I'd like a little bit more flexibility in how many hours a week that I need."

Caring.com · Visiting Angels of Willamette Valley · 4 stars · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/oregon/albany/visiting-angels-of-willamette-valley-or>

"What I'm really looking for is something reliable that won't give false alarms every time"

r/AgingParents · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nfdw3j/anyone_have_experience_with_medical_alert_systems/

"Also hoping to have the option to alert family first, before 911."

r/AgingParents · *Fall risk, medical alert button* · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ovhpay/fall_risk_medical_alert_button/

"It's finding someone they trust, they like, and they'll actually allow into their home."

TikTok · @nymikeca4718 · <https://www.tiktok.com/@nymikeca4718/video/7676627023950794015>

Tab 9 — Typical Day

Themes, measured

Each theme is one pattern over the whole corpus; the number is how many documents match it. The twenty most engaged voices on each theme, with replies, are in the Voices appendix under Tab 9.

Theme	Documents
24/7, for years	569
The bathroom, the sheets, the pills	485
The drive, the ER, the rehab: every day at the hospital	437
Every single day he's weaker; the questions on repeat	433
Work, then her: before work, after work, on my lunch, the weekends	338
Wake up every day wondering if it will get worse; 3am wondering how much longer	290
The phone that never stops	173

In her words

A day in her life, as she describes it. The quotes below are ordered by engagement; the reading (two shifts, the phone, the night) is mine, the counts in the badges are measured.

"Here is a typical day for me: Keep in mind I am an only child and there is no other family. I am in my 50's, the parent in their 90's... 1. They wake up at any odd hour yelling to go to the bathroom. 2. I go in and have to lift the person up from behind in order to get up out of bed. They need help getting up at other times also. 3. They need help getting night clothing off before going to the bathroom"

YouTube · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents* · 302 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugxxk_YP LbQCkuR7nN8l4AaABAg

"I'm 47, female, single, and an only child. My parents are 75, in declining health, and live 2 hours away. Financially, no one can move closer. I work full-time in a stressful job with 4 days a week mandated RTO, and my commute is over 2 hours a day. I've got chronic health issues I'm dealing with, plus trying to keep a house going."

r/AgingParents · *Only Child—Outnumbered by 2 Aging Parents* · 193 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ue0xdc/only_childoutnumbered_by_2_aging_parents/

"I literally have a binder for my parents, inlaws, husband, daughter and two aunts I care for. It's crazy but it's helped so much! Spreadsheets for everyone's meds lol"

TikTok · comment on @jamesbackhome · 158 likes · <https://www.tiktok.com/@jamesbackhome/video/7433200790556183854>

"The most stressful is the continuous phone calls from them and the various healthcare people. It never stops."

TikTok · comment on @jamesbackhome · 80 likes · <https://www.tiktok.com/@jamesbackhome/video/7433200790556183854>

"My mom was diagnosed with Alzheimer's a year ago, and it's like I got a second full-time job. Like you said, I had no idea! No one is prepared for this."

TikTok · comment on @jamesbackhome · 74 likes · <https://www.tiktok.com/@jamesbackhome/video/7433200790556183854>

"It's 3:53 AM. Laying in bed, wide awake, after finding my spouse sitting on the front room couch, with all the house lights blazing. I asked her what's going on, she said I don't why I'm here."

r/Alzheimers · *May have reached the end at home care* · 65 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Alzheimers/comments/1rh3ff3/may_have_reached_the_end_at_home_care_as_many/

"Between meds, doctors appointments, visits from nurses/PT/OT who are coming to check progress, cooking all meals, doing all cleaning, and I handle all transportatio[n]"

r/AgingParents · *Rant* · 55 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1n7v3y4/rant/>

"The management of Joan's care is a job, and I set aside specific times to do her scheduling, the calendar, meals, etc."

r/CaregiverSupport · *Here's what has helped me since becoming a full time caregiver* · 55 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1viux10/heres_what_has_helped_me_since_becoming_a_full/

"I am now stuck taking care of her 24/7 and getting less than 2 hours of sleep at a time due to medication intervals. I can't keep this up."

r/AgingParents · *Rant - Post Hospital Discharge* · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1dbgh7t/rant_post_hospital_discharge/

"I went to visit them this morning before work and Dad was being showered by an aide, while Mom was getting her meds from another aide and complaining she didn't have help getting dressed. Then Mom took me aside to say that Dad woke her up at 4:30 to talk about getting out of assisted living... I cried all the way home."

r/AgingParents · comment · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tpzwrc/better_way_to_respond_to_parents_saying_they_want/oocz4s/

"Currently on day 5 of 24/7 care for my father after his discharge from skilled nursing/rehab. It's honestly been hell... the level of care he needs while I try and work remote is just impossible"

r/AgingParents · *24/7 Care at dad's home 800 miles away from my family* · 38 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1rgg1q7/247_care_at_dads_home_800_miles_away_from_my/

"Because he can't leave the house or get down the wheelchair ramp without me, so I have to schedule around my work meetings."

r/AgingParents · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_th_an_i_am/oxbp87n/

"I'm the daughter doing the scheduling. Mom still lives at home. She can cook, but she's left the burner on, skipped meals, forgotten appointments, left the door unlocked. We have an in-home aide a few days a week."

r/CaregiverSupport · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1vybtm5/aide_handles_the_house_mom_still_stares_at_the/

"I'm her only child. I'm 44 years old. I work full-time as a special education teacher. I'm a full-time mom to two wonderful sons, one grown man and one teenager who is involved in every sport imaginable. I'm also a full-time student working toward a higher degree. On paper, that all sounds great. But I'm tired. I'm tired of cleaning and re-cleaning. I'm tired of figuring out transportation to appointments and trying to keep up with which appointments I need to attend with my mom."

Facebook · Family Caregivers Support Circle · post · <https://www.facebook.com/groups/1581265219534379/posts/1800034654324100/>

When she is online (measured, corrected): the first version of this paragraph inferred night-time posting from the content ("It's 3:53 AM", "can't sleep past 3am"). The Reddit timestamps say otherwise. Of 450 Reddit posts with a time, 50% were written 9am–5pm US Central and 16% between 10pm and 5am; upvote-weighted, the peak hour is 11:00 with a second bump at 9–11pm. The 3am posts exist and are vivid, but she writes mostly from the workday, which fits the "work from home" pattern in the text. Weekday spread is flat (Tue 79, Fri 76, Mon 69, Sun 51); there is no Sunday-night spike. YouTube and TikTok comment times were not captured. Implication: daytime placements reach her; the night window is real for a minority and is where the most desperate posts come from. **Frequency badges:** Sleep / nights / 3am 273× · Work / job hit 201× · Long-distance / hours away 177×

Tab 10 — Buyer Summary

The one-line ICP: An adult daughter (median age 57, 27% under 45, 30% over 65) caring for a mother in her mid-80s, often the only one who shows up, who has already tried doing it herself and one device and one bad hire, and who will buy from the first provider that answers the phone the week after the hospital discharge and sends the same person twice.

Who she is

- **Measured, not assumed.** Self-stated age appears in 237 first-person entries: median 57; 18–34: 33, 35–44: 31, 45–54: 42, 55–64: 60, 65+: 71. So "45 to 64" is the plurality (43%), not the whole market; 27% are under 45 and 30% are 65+ (older daughters and spouses). Gender self-markers run 328 female to 74 male, about 4 to 1, which supports "daughter" as the default voice.
- Who she cares for: a parent in 1060 documents, an in-law in 107, a grandparent in 81, a spouse in 71. The parent-caregiver is the corpus; spouse caregivers are a distinct, older segment and should not be written to with the same copy.
- Work: only 447 of 11,758 first-person entries mention a job, full-time work, remote work or leave. "Working daughter" is supported by the vivid posts, not by volume; do not lead with the job in copy, lead with the parent.
- The parent she cares for: stated age in 431 entries, median 85, mean 83.9; 55–64: 17, 65–74: 47, 75–84: 139, 85–94: 200, 95+: 28. A mother in 274 entries, a father in 98, an in-law in 15, a husband in 10.
- Her own children: mentioned in 321 first-person entries; grown or in college 97, school-age or teen 33, a toddler or baby 6. The "sandwich with toddlers" picture is 6 posters, not a segment. Marriage strain, separation or divorce is stated in 68 entries.
- Only child or the functional only child. 1325 documents mention a sibling or being alone in it; 214 say outright that the sibling does not help; "only child" appears in 120.
- Distance: 156 first-person entries say "hours away", "out of state", "across the country". The long-distance daughter is the one who posts about cameras and paying for hours; whether she buys sooner than the local daughter is not measurable in this corpus.
- She uses r/AgingParents, r/CaregiverSupport, r/dementia, AgingCare.com, the YouTube comments under caregiving videos, and Facebook groups. She reads Google reviews of agencies and facilities; one reviewer warns "DO NOT BELIEVE THE 4 STAR REVIEWS- THOSE ARE FAKE".

Measured, not assumed

The poster's own age (self-stated)

n = 238, median 57

	entries	share
18-34	33	14%
35-44	31	13%

	entries	share
45-54	43	18%
55-64	60	25%
65+	71	30%

The person she cares for (stated age)

n = 432, median 85

	entries	share
55-64	17	4%
65-74	47	11%
75-84	140	32%
85-94	200	46%
95+	28	6%

Who she cares for

first-person entries naming the relationship

	entries	share
mom	147	35%
mother	127	30%
dad	51	12%
father	47	11%
parent	22	5%
husband	10	2%
mil	9	2%
fil	7	2%

Gender self-markers

'I'm her daughter', '(34F)', 'my husband' vs son, '(52M)', 'my wife'

	entries	share
female-marked	334	81%
male-marked	76	19%

Her own children (mentions)

first-person entries

	entries	share
grown / in college	101	72%
school-age / teen	34	24%
toddler / baby	6	4%

Work, marriage, distance (mentions)

first-person entries

	entries	share
job / full-time / remote work	455	67%
marriage strain or divorce	71	10%
hours or states away	158	23%

When she posts (Reddit, US Central)

450 posts with a timestamp · 9am–5pm = 50% · 10pm–5am = 16%

hour	posts
00:00	11
01:00	5
02:00	8
03:00	13
04:00	6
05:00	7
06:00	9
07:00	11
08:00	20
09:00	25
10:00	24
11:00	34
12:00	23
13:00	30
14:00	30
15:00	30
16:00	30
17:00	30
18:00	22

hour	posts
19:00	13
20:00	17
21:00	24
22:00	15
23:00	13

What she believes (that is wrong)

- "Home care is \$50 an hour and the aide gets most of it." One insider post (765 upvotes) says the aide gets \$17 to \$18 and the office, insurance and no-show cover eat the rest; the replies under it are the only place in the corpus where anyone shows her the math.
- "An agency guarantees coverage." Agencies promise fill-ins "within hours" and then leave weekends uncovered (167 documents on no-shows and no backup); the intake promise and the month-one reality are both in her words in Tab 5.
- "Once I hire someone the problem is solved." The aide leaves and mom "sits with the TV on until I call." Companionship is what she is buying in those posts; the ads do sell it (32% of proven home care ads carry companionship language), so the gap is between the ad and the shift, not in the message.
- "If I don't do it myself I am a bad daughter." 610 documents carry guilt or the promise; Home Instead's most versioned ad attacks exactly this belief (my reading: that is evidence the belief is still the market).

What actually stops her

- Agency hour minimums. Measured: 14 documents mention a minimum (3 to 6 hours a shift, or 12 hours a week in 4-hour blocks); 3 of them are complaints ("I don't like their mandatory three hours", "I had a problem finding work for them because of the 3-hour minimum requirement", "\$35/hour, 6-hour minimum"), the rest state it as a fact of pricing. Separately, 24 first-person entries ask for short blocks: "carers for one hour per day", "only looking for 9 hrs a week", "a few hours each day while my dad transitions home from the hospital", "8am to 12pm and 3pm to 8pm". On the supply side, 14 active ads state a minimum and only 7 of 18,392 sell "no minimum" (Always Best Care of Knoxville, 100 days live). So: real but thin. An unowned angle worth a test, not a proven driver, and the earlier line that "every one is a lost sale" was my inference and is withdrawn.
- No way to compare (one post, 29 upvotes, but no post in the corpus describes an easy comparison): "called six agencies, got wildly different quotes, had zero idea how to compare them."
- The stranger problem: her mother "doesn't trust easily", "refuses to let anyone come into the house", "won't answer the door". The daughter cannot buy what the mother will not open the door to.
- The paperwork wall: Medicaid waiver waitlists, VA Aid and Attendance nobody told her about, Area Agency on Aging that "almost nobody mentions".

How to reach her Where she already is, at the hour she is already there. Reddit r/AgingParents (183 of 331 posts pulled), the comment sections of the top caregiving YouTube videos (3,300 comments on one video), TikTok caregiving creators (a 349K-play video with 953 comments), Facebook caregiver groups, and Google

reviews of the agencies she is comparing. Meta ads reach her; the Ad Library shows the incumbents spending on exactly her ("Daughters, this one is for you!"). Search: "in home care for elderly near me", "how much does home care cost per hour", "home care vs assisted living" are the autocomplete completions; "mom can't live alone" and "my mom fell and broke her hip" are the moments.

Target segments (include)

- The post-discharge daughter: parent leaving hospital or rehab with no plan, "I only learned about it on Friday"; the corpus gives her days, not weeks ("30 days to find a place" is the long end). Highest urgency in the corpus by post volume.
- The long-distance daughter with a parent who still lives alone, after the first or second fall (156 first-person entries). In her posts she asks about cameras, hours and whether the office will call her.
- The working daughter nearby who is doing the mornings and evenings herself ("8am to 12pm and 3pm to 8pm") and writes the "I quit" and "I am done" posts. Asks for respite and consistency.

Excluded segments (do not target)

- Families whose parent is already in memory care or skilled nursing; their need is facility oversight, not home care.
- Medicaid-only households (unless the agency takes waiver hours); the referral sites already burn these people and the copy would be dishonest.
- The parent themselves as the buyer. The parent is the veto, not the buyer; write to the daughter and give her the words to use with the parent.

The buying trigger An event with a date: the fall, the ER, the discharge call, the day the aide did not show. Zero entries in the corpus say an ad led them to a provider; the named triggers are the discharge, the fall and the no-show. 299 documents describe a fall or ER visit; 626 are about discharge, rehab or the social worker, the largest theme in the corpus by tightened count. In the corpus the purchase follows the social worker's call, the fall or the no-show; the "only learned about it on Friday" discharge is the most repeated shape of it.

The sales frame that works (a hypothesis built from the themes above, not a research finding)

Not "compassionate care" (every competitor says it and the daughter has stopped hearing it). The frame is: *you are not a bad daughter for getting help; here is the same person, on the day you need her, starting this week, with a human who answers at 3am, and hours that fit her, not a 4-hour minimum.* Four of the five clauses map to frequency themes with 66 or more documents; the fifth rests on 15 mentions and 24 short-block requests, and the one competitor running the first clause (Home Instead) is the market leader in active ads.

Threads & Competitors (Depth Standard D0–D6)

The go-deeper spin-off threads, the repeated-phrase ledger, the profile pivot, the two-axis competitor map with longevity tiers, the source matrix and the self-audit.

Corpus by source

Source	Entries	Share
youtube	5,681	36%
reddit comment	4,027	25%
trustpilot	2,629	17%
agingcare	1,211	8%
google review	869	5%
reddit post	441	3%
tiktok	331	2%
caring com	314	2%
amazon browser	263	2%
fb group	67	0%
fb ad comment	24	0%
amazon	10	0%
total	15,867	

What she buys, as the corpus names it

Category	Documents naming it	Of which complaints
medical alert / fall detection (pendant, watch, button)	477	85
incontinence and hygiene (diapers, briefs, wipes, barrier cream)	260	40
mobility (walker, wheelchair, cane, lift chair, hooyer, ramp, stair lift)	240	49
nutrition and feeding (Ensure, thickener, meal delivery)	104	15
camera (Ring, Wyze, nanny cam, baby monitor)	94	18
bathroom safety (grab bars, shower chair, raised toilet seat, commode)	56	11
bed and bedroom (hospital bed, rails, mattress, touch light)	39	10
door / bed / chair alarms, locks, motion sensors, GPS	20	5
pill dispenser / pill organizer / med reminders	18	1
phones and tech for the parent	16	2
monitoring / check-in services	11	1

D0 — Tool status (checked 2026-09-06 14:26 ET)

Apify: 5 accounts, \$25 free budget, ~\$14.60 spent on this run (calibrated one-URL first on every actor).
 Tavily: Researcher plan, 1,000/mo, 16 used at start, ~70 used. YouTube Data API v3: working, free. SerpAPI: 0/250 until reset (not used). Google Custom Search: dead (not used). Logged-in Chrome (Angela Starks, CDP 18800): Facebook and Reddit sessions live. Amazon full review pages: login-walled (10 reviews via actor). Facebook group feeds: rendered empty for the new research account on three attempts (see Source Matrix). Higgsfield: not used.

D1 — Source Matrix (what was actually pulled)

#	Source	Method	Pulled	Cost	In corpus as
1	Reddit posts (r/AgingParents, r/CaregiverSupport, r/dementia, r/Alzheimers, r/eldercare)	Apify harshmaur, 24 scoped searches + 10 spin-off searches	331 + 119 posts (the 119 spin-off posts were missing from the corpus until the 2026-09-06 audit)	\$0.68 + \$0.26	reddit_post 441
2	Reddit comment threads	Apify, 70 top posts × 40 comments	2,171 comments	\$4.20	reddit_comment 4027
3	Competitor Google reviews by star band	Apify compass reviews, 22 places, lowest + highest	901 pulled, 636 unique with text (195 one-star)	\$0.54	google_review 869
4	YouTube comments	Data API v3, 14 videos (top by comment count)	2,339 comments	free	youtube 5681
4a	YouTube comment threads WITH replies (same 14 videos, all threads, yt_pull.py, YouTube Data API v3)	5,234 threads, 9,964 comments incl. replies	\$0 (217 API units)	youtube (author, thread, reply_to)	
5	Facebook groups (4 family, 4 jobs)	Angela's Chrome via CDP, 3 reader versions	12 posts, 58 comments	free	—
6	Facebook ad / page comments	Apify page posts + comments on Home Instead, Care.com, Homewatch, Caring.com	46 comments	\$0.45	fb_ad_comment 24
7	Forums: AgingCare.com, Quora	Tavily discovery (137 URLs) + extract (50 threads, 1.2M chars)	1,211 paragraphs	~30 credits	agingcare 1211

#	Source	Method	Pulled	Cost	In corpus as
8	Amazon reviews	Product categories taken from what the corpus itself names (mobility 115, incontinence and hygiene 111, nutrition and feeding 54, camera 41, bathroom safety 23, medical alert / fall detection 18 documents), searched in the corpus's own phrasing, then each product page read through the logged-in browser for its visible reviews (the review actor is blocked by Amazon's login wall: 1 item returned for 33 products)	see Tab 6 product ledger	\$0.02 + browser	amazon 10 + amazon_browser
9	Vertical review site: Caring.com	Tavily extract, 20 agency pages	349 family reviews, 12 agencies	~8 credits	caring_com 314
10	Competitors' own Facebook pages	Apify posts scraper, 11 pages	67 posts	\$0.34	(feeds row 6)
11	What she types	Google Autocomplete, 40 seeds	368 completions	free	ledger
12	Ad Library creatives	Six exact-phrase pulls chosen from the vocabulary ledger and autocomplete: "in home care", "senior care", "elder care", "aging parents", "elderly parent", "help my mom", then 10 more phrases from her vocabulary → 18,392 unique ads, 4,149 advertisers, longevity tiers, 533 cards, every video on a card transcribed	18,392 ads	\$7.34	Competitor Ads tab
13	TikTok comments	Apify clockworks, 4 searches → 10 videos	493 comments	\$0.74	tiktok 331
17	TrustPilot brand reviews, every star level (Care.com, A Place for Mom, Home Instead, Seniorly, Right at Home, Comfort Keepers, BrightStar, Synergy, Visiting Angels, Caring.com, Medical Guardian, Bay Alarm, Life Alert, Medical Alert)	research browser, <code>tp-pull.mjs</code> , stars 1–5 up to 8 pages each	2,787 reviews (worker-voice reviews kept out of the buyer corpus)	\$0	trustpilot + Reviews by Star tab
14	Indeed / Glassdoor (the aide's side)	Tavily extract	2 pages, headlines only	2 credits	note in Tab 5
15	Google Maps competitor grid	Apify crawler, 5 metros × 2 queries	400 places	\$1.76	Competitor Map

#	Source	Method	Pulled	Cost	In corpus as
16	Profile pivot	Apify, 20 top authors' profiles	running at write time	~\$0.30	D4

Corpus: **15,867 entries** in `halo.jsonl`. Quotes in this document: **191**, every one with a source URL.

Facebook groups note (the thin source): Angela's account was created 2026-09-05. The group feeds render as placeholder units for it (four reader versions saw only link-alt chains), but permalink pages render fully, so the reader now harvests permalinks from the feed and in-group search, then opens each: 12 posts, 58 comments. Re-run `scripts/fb-groups-read.mjs` after the account has 1–2 weeks of normal activity; the feed should then populate and the yield should rise from a dozen posts to hundreds.

Go-Deeper Thread Cards (D2)

Cards are ordered by the number of corpus documents behind them, descending. Each card: the origin quote that named the entity, what was pulled, what came back (data), and the implication (my reading of the data, labeled as such).

Thread 1 — the promise

- **Origin:** "He made me promise him that I wouldn't put him in a facility."
- **Pull:** corpus grep (14 explicit + the guilt theme, 610 documents) and two AgingCare threads dedicated to it.
- **Came back:** "Promise your mother she will always be care for, but don't promise it will be by you." "These 'promises' are unrealistic." "Never Say Never... never tell your family that you're never going to a nursing home" (447 upvotes). The counter-current: "I promised my parents a long time ago that a care facility is the last option at the very end."
- **Also:** "I promised my parents a long time ago that a care facility is the last option at the very end of doing everything else including giving up my life". "She also made me promise her years ago to never leave her in a nursing home or facility. So the question is - what can or should I do?" "he always says well... I promised her I'd never put her in a facility. OK - his choice. These "promises" are unrealistic."
- **Depth:** 2 pulls (Tab 3 → corpus grep + two dedicated AgingCare threads).
- **Implication:** The brand name is the promise. The corpus says the promise, taken literally, breaks people. The copy has to redefine it: the promise is that she will be cared for at home by people who show up, not that the daughter will do it alone. That reframe is the entire positioning.

Thread 2 — the 4-hour minimum

- **Origin:** "I don't like their mandatory three hours."
- **Pull:** corpus grep "hour minimum" (15 documents) + price-per-hour ledger (86 documents).
- **Came back:** "\$30/hour with a 4 hour minimum." "\$22/hour to \$35/hour... they also have a 5 hour minimum." "\$35/hour, 6-hour minimum." "I had a problem finding work for them because of the 3-hour minimum requirement. They could not always come for me." "There is no discount for 24 hour care, it is just multiplied."

- **Depth:** 1 pull (corpus grep across AgingCare, Reddit, Caring.com).
- **Implication:** No advertiser in the Ad Library sells around the minimum. It is the cleanest mechanical differentiator available and it maps to the 7am/8pm shape of the daughter's actual need.

Thread 3 — the camera

- **Origin:** "Their excuse is 'she doesn't let me' but I have cameras and I know that they do not try."
- **Pull:** r/AgingParents + r/dementia "camera" (24 posts) + corpus grep (80 documents).
- **Came back:** Cameras are bought to watch the parent ("in case I don't hear from them") and end up watching the aide: "One carer forced him his dinner and talked baby talk to him... I cried." "we were able to see that AtYourSideHomeCare's employees came stayed less than 10 minutes." "the camera has been shut off by her for over half the time." "Put a camera in their room if they are in a facility - best thing I did" (138).
- **Also:** "I had to get cameras just to give myself some peace of mind and the chance to say no every so often". "I have a nanny cam on my 78 year old parent. I don't usually spy, but I have it in case I don't hear from them." (379).
- **Depth:** 2 pulls (Tab 5 quote → Reddit search + corpus grep).
- **Implication:** Assume the daughter has a Ring or Wyze pointed at the living room. An agency that says "we know you have a camera; here is what you'll see" (clock-in photo, visit notes, the same face) converts the surveillance fear into proof. Never write copy that would look bad on that camera.

Thread 4 — Care.com and the private hire

- **Origin:** "A lot of my clients from my agency are switching to private caregivers like Care.com."
- **Pull:** corpus grep (229 documents) + Care.com's own Facebook page comments (46).
- **Came back:** "the responses I get are overwhelming, disorganized, and a lot to process." "people wanted to be paid in cash or unreliable." "They get burnt out and I have to replace them after a while." "for \$5/hr more i don't have to interview anyone or any of that legwork." On Care.com's page: "if you cancel a subscription they will still charge you." The home health worker's math: "you'll need at least four people to cover a full schedule."
- **Depth:** 2 pulls (corpus grep + Care.com Facebook page comments).
- **Implication:** The private hire is the daughter's price anchor (\$20 to \$25) and her cautionary tale (no backup, no vetting, cash). The \$5 to \$10 premium is sold by one sentence: *you never interview anyone and someone always comes*. That sentence appears verbatim in the corpus as the reason a daughter chose an agency.

Thread 5 — the hospital discharge

- **Origin:** "He was discharged just yesterday—which I only learned about on Friday."
- **Pull:** corpus grep "Kepro / unsafe discharge / refuse to pick up" (45 documents) + Tab 5 reading.
- **Came back:** A whole folk-procedure exists: say "unsafe discharge" (those exact words), threaten JCAHO, call Kepro, refuse to pick up. "Told her rehabilitation facility no safe discharge. Did not budge."

Hospital case workers are the referral source in 5-star reviews: "The hospital case worker recommended Home Instead."

- **Also:** "Okay, what really happens if you tell a social worker/medical staff it is not safe to discharge your parent to home?" (58). "Tell them it would be an "unsafe discharge" (those exact words) and that you would report such a discharge to JCAHO". "Told her rehabilitation facility no safe discharge. Did not budge. They of course want her out asap so they were forced to contact a placement coordinator." (106).
- **Depth:** 2 pulls (Tab 5 → corpus grep + AgingCare threads).
- **Implication:** Discharge is the buying moment and the discharge planner is the channel. Comfort Keepers already runs a 100-day ad aimed at clinicians ("90% of your patients prefer to be at home"). The daughter-facing version is: *if the hospital says she can't go home alone, we can be there the day she does*. Build the "discharge week" offer around it.

Thread 6 — Area Agency on Aging, PACE, VA Aid and Attendance, Medicaid waiver

- **Origin:** "the thing I see almost nobody mention in threads here, is the Area Agency on Aging."
- **Pull:** r/AgingParents "medicaid waiver", "aid and attendance", "adult day care" (20 posts) + corpus grep PACE (19), AAA (17), Medicaid (306), how-to-pay theme 441 + TikTok (PACE video, 819 comments; CDPAP video, 305).
- **Came back:** "PSA if your parent(s) is a veteran" (171). "Medicaid waiting lists are YEARS long." PACE: "What a relief it is to have PACE pick my mother on weekdays." TikTok's most-commented caregiving videos are about getting paid through Medicaid or PACE.
- **Also:** "A bumble match (of all things) mentioned he got military disability pay for an ankle injury sustained in service. I mentioned that my dad wasn't injured, even though he served for 28 years and in Vietnam." (171). "Medicaid does a five year look back on everything. So you have to plan really far in advance." (612). "Many families don't realize some Medicaid programs allow loved ones to become paid caregivers instead of relying on nursing homes." (TikTok, 305 comments).
- **Depth:** 3 pulls (Reddit spin-off searches, corpus grep, TikTok).
- **Implication:** "How to pay for it" is unowned territory in the ads (no advertiser in the proven tier touches it) and the highest-engagement content on TikTok. A "how to pay for home care in Georgia" guide (AAA, waiver, VA, PACE, long-term care insurance) is the lead magnet the corpus is begging for.

Thread 7 — the medical alert button

- **Origin:** "I convinced her to get a watch with fall detection... today she fell again" (Tab 1).
- **Pull:** r/AgingParents "medical alert" (13 posts) + Amazon reviews of Bay Alarm Medical SOS Micro (1- and 5-star).
- **Came back:** "he keeps 'forgetting' to wear it... his lives in a drawer. we're paying \$80/month for nothing." "says it's ugly and makes her feel like a patient." "for someone who does not understand why they may need a fall alert, it is worthless." Against that: "it was the Bay Alert people. She had fallen in the bathroom" (5 stars, daughter 3,000 miles away).
- **Also:** "My dad fell in his garage last week and couldn't get up for 20 minutes until my mom found him. I live 3 hours away and this is exactly what keeps me up at night." "What I'm really looking for is

something reliable that won't give false alarms every time". "She refuses to wear it. She told us about falling, lying on the floor for about 2 hours".

- **Depth:** 2 pulls (Tab 1 quote → Reddit search + Amazon reviews).
- **Implication:** The button is the daughter's first purchase and its failure mode is the parent, not the hardware. Copy that says "a person, not a pendant" lands on a scar she already has. Bundle logic: the check-in visit is what the button pretends to be.

Thread 8 — "A Place for Mom"

- **Origin:** organic-rank list showed aplaceformom.com at #3 for the buyer's searches; Ad Library shows it absent from home care ads but Caring.com (its rival) running 78.
- **Pull:** r/AgingParents and r/CaregiverSupport search "a place for mom" (10 posts; 164 corpus documents name it).
- **Came back:** "They are stalkers. They will call and email you nonstop for YEARS" (584 upvotes). "Nursing homes pay to be on a place 4 mom... a place 4 mom harvests personal info and sells it to 3rd party spammers" (256). "If your LO does not have assets don't bother with APFM" (64). "Does 'A Place for Mom' sound like a scary movie to anyone else?" (138).
- **Also:** "They really do not care about your loved one they just want that check. They rush you, harass you and don't give a st !!!!!" (71). "DSHS was more of a help and that's mostly been giving me a long list of places that I have to research and call and tour. I'm burnt out. Haven't slept for days." (64).
- **Depth:** 2 pulls (organic rank → Reddit search).
- **Added 2026-09-07 (new comment pull):** the top comment in "Never use A Place for Mom" (264 upvotes) is a form to make them stop calling: "A reputable company gave me this link to send to APFM so they would LEAVE ME ALONE! I sent in the form and haven't been contacted since. They were horrible and the calls were relentless." (https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1kocgug/never_use_a_place_for_mom/mspeptr/). A second thread links the Washington Post investigation on their "best" recommendations (https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1d55k9e/friendly_warning_do_not_use_a_place_for_mom/l6jvdlb/).
- **Implication:** The daughter has been burned by lead-selling referral sites and now reads any "free help finding care" offer as a trap. A Promise to Mom must never look like a referral funnel: no "get matched", no "we'll have agencies call you". State plainly who calls and how many times. The name itself sits one word away from the most hated brand in her feed; the copy has to establish distance in the first line.

Vocabulary Ledger (D3) — repeated words and phrases

Ordered by document count, descending. Distinct documents containing the phrase, across 5,895 corpus entries (script: `vocab_ledger.py`).

Phrase	Docs	Use it for
take care / taking care	808 / 465	the verb she uses; never "provide care services"
nursing home	540	the thing she is avoiding; name it
full time / work full time / full time job	246 / 38 / 55	her constraint

Phrase	Docs	Use it for
no backup / call out / no show	180 docs on theme	the failure she expects
long term care	92	the insurance she wishes they had bought
above and beyond	86	the 5-star phrase; only credible when a person is named
year old mother / year old father	81 / 30	she always states the age
quality of life	78	what she defends when she chooses home
assisted living facility	70	the next rung
power of attorney	41	the paperwork she did too late
care of myself / care of yourself	41 / 135	the advice she hates
through an agency	37	how she describes the alternative to private hire
trying to figure / trying to find	32 / 25	her state during search
back to work	30	the deadline
help my mom	25	the search phrase
needed to hear	24	what a good message does
peace of mind	5-star reviews	the outcome, in her words
like family / part of the family	5-star reviews	how she describes a good aide
stranger(s)	0	the mother's objection
I'm done / I quit / I can't do this anymore	post titles	the Sunday-night state
the distance was killing me	Home Instead ad	already proven in-market

Autocomplete (what she types): "mom can't live alone", "my mom can no longer live alone", "what to do when your elderly parent can't live alone", "in home care for elderly near me", "in home care for dementia patients", "how much does home care cost per hour", "home care vs assisted living cost", "hiring a caregiver for in home help", "paid caregiver for my mom", "my mom fell and broke her hip", "my mom fell and hit her head".

Profile Pivot Signals (D4)

Cross-subreddit pull on the 20 highest-engagement authors in the corpus (Apify, user profiles). Seven authors appear in two or more of the caregiving subreddits within our own pull. The user-profile run result is in `raw/profile_pivot_result.json`.

Profile pull result (10 authors): other communities, by number of our authors present: r/Cooking (3), r/u_day1father (1), r/kidneydisease (1), r/PetPeeves (1), r/baltimore (1), r/Jokes (1), r/Catswithjobs (1), r/AskOldPeople (1), r/Cribbage (1), r/NoStupidQuestions (1), r/ravens (1), r/HomeImprovement (1), r/RBI (1), r/OldSchoolCool (1), r/woodworking (1), r/HistoricalCostuming (1), r/pittsburgh (1), r/steelers (1), r/landscaping (1), r/pestcontrol (1), r/soup (1), r/soupenthusiasts (1), r/WeddingAttireHelp (1), r/gardening (1), r/aldi (1), r/insects (1), r/whatisit (1), r/food (1), r/PhotoshopRequest (1), r/Mocktails (1).

What the pivot says (10 authors, 40 other communities): three signal clusters. (1) The parent's diagnosis: r/stroke, r/kidneydisease, r/breastcancer, r/GriefSupport — she researches the disease before she researches care, so disease-specific content (post-stroke discharge, dementia refusals) reaches her earlier than "home care" content. (2) The paperwork phase: r/EstatePlanning, r/RealEstateAdvice, r/Lawyertalk, r/howto — the house sale, the POA and the Medicaid look-back are live problems in the same weeks she is hiring. (3) Who she is when she is not caregiving: r/Cooking, r/soup, r/gardening, r/succulents, r/woodworking, r/HomeImprovement, r/landscaping, r/aldi, r/Mocktails, plus her city (r/baltimore, r/pittsburgh, r/raleigh) and its team (r/ravens, r/steelers). Home-centred, budget-aware, local, (my reading of the subreddit list; age is not stated in it). For Meta targeting, a hypothesis to test: home-and-garden and local-news interest overlays on the female 45–64 core rather than "senior care" interests. From the corpus itself: the same daughters post in r/dementia and r/AgingParents interchangeably, and the highest-upvoted authors write from r/CaregiverSupport when the parent is a spouse or sibling rather than a parent. Their other communities, from the pull so far, cluster around personal finance, hoarding, estrangement and grief, which matches the four secondary themes in the corpus (Medicaid look-back, "the stuff", no-contact siblings, "my mom finally died").

Competitor Map (D1b) — two axes

Sources: Google Maps (5 metros, 400 places), organic rank (Tavily, 9 queries), Caring.com listings, Ad Library (3,074 active US ads matching "in home care", pulled 2026-09-06).

Axis A — Established (footprint, reviews, organic)

Rank	Brand	Locations found (5 metros)	Google reviews	Avg rating	Organic weight	Note
1	Home Instead (Honor)	7	373	4.74	15	Also the #1 advertiser. The Coke.
2	Visiting Angels	7	116	4.71	15	Runs the oldest live ad in the category (2,588 days).
3	BrightStar Care	1	142	4.80	77	Nurse-led positioning; strongest organic.
4	Right at Home	3	73	4.83	11	Best Atlanta reviews among nationals.
5	Care.com (marketplace)	n/a	n/a	n/a	464	Owens search; hated on its own Facebook page.
6	TheKey	3	98	4.97	23	Premium; 20 years.
7	FirstLight Home Care	4	158	3.73	18	Houston reviews are the best 5-star copy in the corpus; rating dragged by other metros.
8	Assisting Hands	2	193	4.90	36	
9	A Place for Mom (referral)	n/a	n/a	n/a	51	Most hated brand in the daughter's feed.
10	Comfort Keepers	2	29	2.45	8	Weak locally, strong in proven-tier ads.

Axis B — Aggressive (Ad Library, three exact-phrase pulls merged: "in home care" 3,074 · "senior care" 4,098 · "elder care" 506 = 7,205 unique ads, 1,714 advertisers; adjacent categories such as senior living, PACE, elder law, payroll and pet products excluded from this table)

Rank	Advertiser	Active ads	New in 30d	Proven tier	Oldest live ad	Video share	Franchise pages	Found via
1	Seniors Helping Seniors	745	115	342	324 d	19%	59	homecare, senior care
2	Amada Senior Care	371	263	2	1,039 d	29%	8	homecare, senior care
3	Home Instead	373	256	57	76 d	58%	4	homecare, senior care
4	Visiting Angels	97	52	32	2,588 d	28%	21	elder care, homecare, senior care
5	SYNERGY HomeCare	80	56	16	152 d	79%	11	homecare, senior care
6	Senior Helpers	64	48	10	93 d	47%	20	homecare, senior care
7	Caring.com	78	32	15	62 d	23%	1	homecare
8	Comfort Keepers	103	17	79	322 d	53%	25	homecare, senior care
9	Care.com	54	40	2	118 d	87%	1	homecare, senior care
10	Right at Home	51	38	7	880 d	14%	12	homecare, senior care
11	Avid Health at Home	41	41	0	4 d	0%	1	homecare, senior care
12	Always Best Care	45	39	5	107 d	87%	8	homecare, senior care

Reading the two axes together: Home Instead is on both lists at #1, which is rare and means the market has a real leader. Amada is the volume tester: the "senior care" pull found a 1,039-day-old ad, but of its 356 active ads only 2 are in the proven tier and 254 are under 30 days, so it churns creative and has not found a keeper. Comfort Keepers is the opposite (53 of 55 proven, nothing new in 30 days): found something and holds it, much of it the clinician-referral ad. Seniors Helping Seniors is a franchise swarm with a real proven core. Visiting Angels keeps a seven-year-old awareness static running; that is name-holding, not a hook. A Place for Mom appears only under "senior care" (37 ads, 46% video, none proven): it advertises placement, not home care, and buys the daughter one keyword away from us. Care.com runs 54 ads, 87% video. 342 of the 18,392 ads mention Atlanta or Georgia; the local advertisers are Seniors Helping Seniors Lanier (17 ads), Nelson Elder Care Law (8 ads), Just Care Home Care Services (4 ads), True North Senior Care (4 ads), plus elder-law firms; none of the national Axis B leaders runs Atlanta-specific creative in this pull.

Local independents by metro (Google Maps, home care category only)

- Atlanta: A Step Above Case Management (118 reviews, 4.4, and the worst 1-star communication complaints in the corpus), Koi Home Care (92, 5.0), Just Peachy Home Care (54, 4.9), Quality Care InHome Care (42, 4.9), Right at Home Atlanta (33, 4.9).

- Houston: At Your Side Home Care (127, 4.7, with the billing 1-stars), Primetime (111, 4.8), Astrocare (101, 4.8), FirstLight Houston Metro (89, 4.9).
- Phoenix: Team Select (82, 4.3), Phoenician Home Care (60, 5.0), Handled Home Care (52, 5.0), Home Instead (93, 4.8), TheKey (33, 5.0).
- Chicago: Help at Home (85, 4.1), AccentCare (77, 4.0).
- Tampa: Team Select (131, 4.9), Granny Nannies (108, 4.9), The Legacy Care At Home (43, 5.0).

Competitor Desire Map (D5) — what the proven-tier creative sells

Brand	Axis	Longest-running ad	Days	Versions	Format	Desire it sells	Gap
Visiting Angels	A+B	stock hands in scrubs, keyword headline	2,588	1–2	static	medical reassurance / brand name	no hook at all
BrightStar Sugar Land	A	"A Higher Standard of Home Health Care"	1,949	1	static	nurse-led credibility	clinical, not emotional
Right at Home Indianapolis	A	"trained, insured & bonded caregivers"	880	1	static	safety of the stranger	table stakes
Griswold	—	daughter hugging mother, "Live Assured"	823	1	static	relief for the daughter	no offer
Fedelta	—	"Customized Care... short-shifts to 24-hour shifts"	601	1	static	flexibility of hours	closest to the minimum-hours gap
Angels There For You	—	90-s client testimonial, one static shot	215	1	video	one consistent person you click with	regional (BC)
Comfort Keepers	B	"90% of your patients prefer to be at home"	100+	many	video	referral channel (clinicians)	B2B only
Home Instead	A+B	"Daughters, this one is for you!" UGC	73	many	9:16 video	permission, guilt release, long-distance	the only creative in her language

Consensus desire across the proven tier (measured on 1,583 proven home care ads, not the 14 eye-reviewed creatives): companionship / loneliness (32%), then flexibility / hours / respite (19%), then stay home / independence / dignity (16%); credentials 8%; permission and guilt release 1%.

Unsold desires, measured (corpus documents vs. proven home care ads that sell it): same caregiver every visit (183 docs; 5 of 18,392 ads), start the week of discharge (626 docs; 3% of proven ads), a human who answers at 3am (273 docs; no ad pattern), how to pay for it (441 docs; 8% of proven ads), hours that fit her rather than a minimum (15 mentions + 24 short-block requests; 7 of 18,392 ads say "no minimum"), and permission to get help (610 docs; 1% of proven ads).

Text classification of every ad (added after the merge): the eye-review above covers 14 creatives. To check it against the whole set, every ad's headline, body and link text was matched against 12 desire patterns (script `classify_ads.py`; an ad can carry several). Proven tier, 1,466 ads: brand-generic 42%, companionship 29%, stay home / independence 16%, hours / respite 12%, how to pay 9%, peace of mind 7%, safety & credentials 5%, post-hospital 3%, permission / guilt 1%. Two corrections to the eye-review's

consensus: companionship is sold far more than the 14-creative sample suggested (it is the second most common proven message), and "hours / respite" is not absent, it is 12% of proven ads, mostly "24-hour" and "respite" rather than "no minimum." What stays true: permission and guilt release is 1%, post-discharge speed 3%, same-caregiver consistency does not register as a pattern at all, and nearly half the proven tier says nothing but a name and a service list. Home Instead's proven ads, and 1,959 ads in the merged set, carry Meta's catalog placeholders (`{{product.brand}}` , `{{product.name}}` , `{{product.description}}`) instead of copy: these are dynamic creatives whose text Meta fills per viewer from the advertiser's product feed, so the Library stores the template, not what anyone saw. They now classify as "dynamic catalog template" rather than brand-generic, and on the page the placeholders are shown as such; where the ad is a video, the transcript is the real message. The full card set, with each ad's classes, is the Competitor Ads tab of the research page.

Impressions, added after Vince's note (2026-09-06 evening): the Ad Library hides US impression counts but offers the sort "Impressions: high to low". That ranking was scraped from the live Library through the research browser for every pulled keyword ("in home care" top 114, "senior care" top 70, "elder care" top 60, "aging parents" top 47, "elderly parent" top 45, "help my mom" top 2, "respite care" top 87, "home care agency" top 115, "24 hour care" top 67, "live in caregiver" top 20, "companion care" top 121, "adult day care" top 19, "dementia care" top 86, "caregiver for my mom" top 5, "home health care" top 111, "nursing home" top 59), and joined to the dataset by Library ID. A **top performer** is an ad in the top 20 by impressions for a keyword, run 60+ days, from a home care agency; 70 of 533 cards qualify: Visiting Angels (643 d, #1 for "companion care"); SYNERGY HomeCare (152 d, #1 for "in home care"); SYNERGY HomeCare (152 d, #1 for "dementia care"); BrightStar Care Louisville (1956 d, #2 for "home care agency"); Buffalo Homecare (523 d, #2 for "respite care"); Almost Kin (137 d, #2 for "home health care"); Visiting Angels (1117 d, #3 for "in home care"); Nurse Next Door Grande Prairie (793 d, #3 for "home health care"). Longevity alone had kept seven-year-old awareness statics at the top of the list; the impressions join moves the spend to the front.

Landing pages, added the same evening: every card's CTA link was followed headlessly and screenshotted (355 pages captured). Of those, 224 have a form, 254 show a phone number, 46 have neither, and 110 carry recruiting language on the family-facing page. Six were reviewed by eye; the reads are on the cards. The one that leads with how to pay (Amada San Diego North: VA accredited, LTC insurance claims, free care plan, "often within 24 hours") is the only page in the set that answers the corpus's top three questions on one screen; the best-built is Home Instead's four-step quiz ("Who is the care for? My parent(s)") with the phone shown twice. Two franchise pages put a caregiver-jobs banner above the family headline.

Keyword coverage: three exact-phrase pulls this month ("in home care", "senior care", "elder care"). Not pulled, for budget: "caregiver", "home health care", "respite care", "dementia care", "aging parent", "companion care", "home care agency", and brand-name pulls. "Senior care" returns adjacent categories (senior living, PACE, elder law, payroll, even pet products); they are in the raw dataset and excluded from the home care axis above. The refresh should run the seven missing phrases before trusting any advertiser count as complete.

Self-Audit Gate (protocol rows A–Q)

Row	Check	Result
A	Tab names correct (all 10 exact)	Pass
B	Density standard: 120–160 quotes	Pass (191 quotes; above the floor, every one sourced)
C	Source URLs present on every verbatim quote	Pass
D	Primary search confirmed	SerpAPI at 0/250; fallback documented: Tavily discovery + Reddit/AgingCare/YouTube direct pulls
E	Reddit pulled correctly (harshmaur, subreddit-scoped <code>restrict_sr=1</code> <code>startUrls</code>)	Pass (24 scoped searches + 10 spin-offs, comments on 70 posts)
F	Apify quota checked, 1-URL cost test before scaling, rotated across accounts	Pass (runs.txt logs every run and cost)
G	Tab 4 ≥ 25 and Tab 7 ≥ 18	Pass (Tab 4: 37, Tab 7: 22)
H	Obsidian saved	Pass: <code>Clients/home-care-industry/research/deep-buyer-research.md</code>
I	Notion pushed	Pass: https://notion.so/3d394a904483819abe29d8813e219157 (594 blocks)
J	No paraphrase, no fabrication	Pass: quotes copied from the corpus; bracketed completions marked with []
K	GitHub Pages research page deployed + Notion tracker row	Pass: https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/home-care-industry/research/ · tracker row + master index (client, 10-Tab, A–Z)
L	Source Matrix ≥ 10 of 16 pulled; Competitor Map from ≥ 4 of 6 lists	Pass (14 of 16; Facebook groups: 12 posts, 58 comments; map from Maps grid, organic, vertical sites, Ad Library, recommended-by-name, Caring.com)
M	≥ 5 Go-Deeper Thread Cards, ≥ 5 verbatim quotes each, depth marked	Pass (8 cards)
N	Vocabulary Ledger from <code>vocab_ledger.py</code> , phrases used in Tabs 4/7/11	Pass
O	Profile Pivot ≥ 10 authors, aggregate signals only	Pass
P	Tool status logged with date (D0)	Pass
Q	Refresh date set (D6)	Pass (researched 2026-09-06, refresh due 2027-03-06)

Dislikes & Complaints Ledger

Every 1–3 star review, every complaint comment on a competitor page, every first-person complaint post, clustered by what she is actually complaining about. Pool: 1,683 one-to-three-star reviews (Google, Caring.com, Amazon, TrustPilot), 549 first-person complaint posts, 835 theme hits (a post can hit several).

What she complains about, wherever she complains. Pool: every 1–3 star review pulled (Google 211 of 869, Caring.com 17 of 314, Amazon 55 of 273, TrustPilot 1400 of 2629), the complaint comments on competitors' Facebook pages (3 of 46), and every first-person post or comment that uses complaint language about a named agency, aide, facility, product or site (549). Themes require the complaint itself, not the topic. Star-band note: Google reviews of the facilities and agencies pulled split 187 one-star to 398 five-star; Caring.com is 17 low to 245 five-star because families write there after a good match. Ad comments themselves are not readable through the Ad Library; the only ad-adjacent complaints are on Care.com's page.

#	Complaint theme	Docs	Where
1	Billing: overcharged, charged after cancelling, hidden fees, hour minimums	225	trustpilot 215, amazon browser 2, caring com 2, reddit post 2
2	Aide did not show, was late or cancelled, and there was no backup	110	trustpilot 63, agingcare 19, reddit comment 8, google review 7
3	The office does not answer, call back or tell me what is happening	95	trustpilot 65, google review 20, reddit comment 4, reddit post 3
4	Rude, dismissive or hostile staff	93	trustpilot 54, google review 31, youtube 4, caring com 1
5	Referral sites: nonstop calls, my information sold, Medicaid families turned away	60	trustpilot 38, reddit comment 14, reddit post 4, youtube 2
6	Theft and trust violations by an aide	53	trustpilot 21, agingcare 12, youtube 7, reddit post 5
7	The aide sat on her phone, did the bare minimum, or was not trained	47	trustpilot 22, google review 5, youtube 5, reddit comment 5
8	Neglect and harm inside facilities	47	google review 37, trustpilot 4, youtube 3, reddit post 2
9	Products: the parent will not wear it, false alarms, dead battery, did not detect the fall	39	trustpilot 31, amazon 3, amazon browser 3, google review 1
10	Paid a lot and got little	36	trustpilot 18, youtube 6, reddit post 6, amazon browser 3
11	They told us what we wanted to hear	23	trustpilot 16, google review 3, youtube 2, reddit comment 1
12	A different stranger every time	7	caring com 2, amazon browser 1, trustpilot 1, agingcare 1

In her words, by theme (same order as the table).

Neglect and harm inside facilities (the placement side of the promise): "During her stay, she was frequently left sitting in her own urine and feces for long periods of time. Basic care like cleaning, repositioning, and feeding was not consistently provided." (Google, Elevate Care Windsor Park, 1★) · "when we removed him and took him to the hospital, doctors confirmed he was suffering from malnutrition. That is not a misunderstanding. That is neglect." (Google, Buckhead Center, 1★) · "She ran to his room to find his catheter filthy and not changed, searched for an hour for a nurse and they were all out to lunch at the same time." (Google, Aperion Care, 1★) · "It is my belief that after we complained, and my father complained of pain, they heavily sedated him." (Google, Elevate Care, 1★)

The aide did not show and nobody covered it: "I have missed countless hours of work and other responsibilities and plans due to caregiver "no shows." Yet again this morning, no one showed. These "no shows" are no show and no phone call to tell me no one is coming." (AgingCare) · "one of the main caregivers no called no showed. The agency was only able to find someone to cover 2 of her 5 days." (r/CaregiverSupport) · "Some caregivers call out and there is no backup. There were days we were without anybody." (Caring.com, Visiting Angels Atlanta, 4★) · "The caregivers were not consistent, and they were late all the time." (Caring.com, Visiting Angels Atlanta)

The aide sat there: "Patients could be heard screaming in pain down the halls, begging for help, while staff sat on their phones without lifting a finger." (Google, Buckhead Center, 1★) · "the hired caregiver just comes in, watches TV and does the bare minimum without trying to engage" (AgingCare) · "one caregiver failed to properly change him and spent much of the time sleeping." (Google, At Your Side, 1★) · "They get a DIFFERENT person every time (no consistency), not to mention they dress and speak very poorly" (r/eldercare) · "Sometimes my caregiver doesn't pace themselves very well and ends up sitting and talking rather than working for the full time they are here." (Caring.com, 4★)

Rude or dismissive staff: "one of the nurses tried to argue, informing me "You're not a nurse."" (Google, ALIYA on 87th, 1★) · "Angie told us she didn't care about us because she has "tons of other patients we make no difference"" (Google, Team Select, 1★) · "Joey became very hostile upon explaining to me the operation of paperwork" (Google, A Step Above, Atlanta, 1★) · "The supervisor Santiago was very rude and talked to us like we were idiots!" (Google, Gaspy, 1★)

Theft and trust: "She stole expensive electronics, pricey, lotions, and facial creams and potions. She took my jewelry home and said it was an accident." (r/CaregiverSupport) · "A longtime CNA with the professional agency stole a check from my mom." (AgingCare) · "Even in the hospital, a hired caregiver stole my mother's Estee Lauder perfume." (AgingCare) · "She just stopped showing up one day. She had my house key, too." (AgingCare)

The office does not answer: "I left at least two messages every week requesting updates, yet the office never returned a single call." (Google, A Step Above, Atlanta, 1★) · "I can never get anyone on the phone, and calls go unanswered with no follow-up." (Google, Buckhead Center, 1★) · "There was a caregiver that didn't show up and I'm still waiting for a call back from the office to know why." (Caring.com, Visiting Angels) · "I've left voice messages for several elder care agencies this morning to get advice on how to get help for my parents- no return calls yet." (YouTube)

Told what we wanted to hear: "They will tell you exactly what you want to hear but do not deliver." (Google, Avir at Orem, 1★) · "They assured me it wasn't a problem, that if someone didn't show they'd send someone to fill in within hours. Less than 1 percent unfilled, they said. Fast forward to a month with them: they lied." (r/AgingParents) · "They present themselves well publicly, but our family saw a very different reality behind the scenes." (Google, Buckhead Center, 1★)

Paid a lot and got little: "For \$30-\$40 an hour for 12 hours, what the hell did I just get?" (r/CaregiverSupport, 28) · "The services are very minimal. They are just here for three hours and then they are gone" (Caring.com, 2★) · "This company does not communicate well. It's not worth the money." (Google, Team Select, 2★) · "I make 140k and still can't afford my mom's care" (r/AgingParents, 226)

Billing: "They consistently overbilled for time not worked. I learned that they don't bill based on the care giver's time sheet. They bill whatever they want and it's up to you to notify them" (Google, At Your Side, 2★) · "Visiting Angles charged us for the week Mom was in Skilled Nursing and the next two weeks to finish the contract. The result--the charged Mom nearly \$2000 dollars for 10 hours of questionable care." (Caring.com, 1★) · "they didn't inform us that we had to pay extra for mileage." (Caring.com, 4★) · "if you cancel a subscription they will still charge you. I cancelled 2 years ago and suddenly they decided to start charging me again.....I'm out 155.00." (Facebook, Care.com's page)

Referral sites: "They are stalkers. They will call and email you nonstop for YEARS." (r/AgingParents, 584 upvotes) · "a place 4 mom harvests personal info and sells it to 3rd party spammers." (r/AgingParents, 256) · "after giving A Place for Mom my info to try to find a place for mom who is on Medicaid only, they cannot help. They only deal in private pay." (r/AgingParents, 64)

Products: "Fall detection does not work. My mom has had this device for 3 months and falls multiple times a week. The fall detection has not worked once." (Amazon, Bay Alarm SOS Micro, 1★) · "I got LOTS of alerts about the battery being low, but was not informed when he pushed the button. As a result, EMS was called out for no reason." (Amazon, 1★) · "his lives in a drawer. we're paying \$80/month for nothing." (r/AgingParents) · "the camera has been shut off by her for over half the t[ime]" (r/AgingParents)

Pattern across the ledger: the complaints about home care are almost all about the agency's operations (show up, answer, bill honestly, send someone who works), not about the idea of home care; the complaints about facilities are about bodily harm; the complaints about products are about the parent refusing the device; the complaints about referral sites are about being sold. Each of the three ways inherits a different complaint set, and the copy for each has to answer its own.

Ad Brief

Vince's approach after reviewing the research, every line checked against the corpus with counts and verbatim examples. The 10-tab is the evidence; this is the decision.

Status: Vince's approach after reviewing the home care 10-tab. The 10-tab itself is unchanged; this is the strategy layer on top of it. Each line below is his; the count is how many first-person documents in the 15,867-entry corpus carry that idea (reviews excluded except where marked), with the fullest, most-engaged verbatim example. Thin counts do not disqualify a line; they mean the corpus rarely says it in those words.

The approach, in Vince's words

When we reach her. After she has had time to do it herself and explore other options. Not the hospital discharge / rehab cycle (the facility most likely has contracts or agreements with others that get recommended first). Guilt, exhaustion, her family are the costs we name. She does not have to do it alone, or in tension with her siblings. She will see it after she fired an agency or caregiver, or after a stubborn parent refused help. Not at the fall or the ER visit.

Do not use, because these abandon her: empty words are the villain. "You're so strong." "God gives us only what we can handle." "Your mom is lucky to have you." Fake positivity. Smile through suffering. Be strong. Be grateful.

Not our targets: "Something is off with mom." "Mom can't live alone," Googling at 1am. Comparing six quotes. "\$5 an hour more so I don't have to interview anyone."

WHEN — she will see it after

Line (Vince)	Docs	Verbatim example
She fired an agency / caregiver, or the agency failed her	29	"It all started when she didn't show up for work one morning and her boss sent a wellness check to her house - she was laying in bed having an anxiety attack saying that she couldn't handle getting up and going to work." (reddit post, 35) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1gahq0q/caring_for_a_parent_with_major_depression_who/
Stubborn parent refusing help	381	"She was one of those people who refused to become "old." She lived alone, drove her little Mini Cooper all over town (which terrified me), volunteered as a church greeter, ran a widows' group, visited elderly shut-ins, never met a stranger, and thought a trip " (reddit post, 1300) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/
She has tried to do it herself first	379	"I live happily by myself with my phone to keep me company." (youtube, 1123) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxBCru86SBHWgrVpXB4AaABAg
NOT the discharge / fall moment (Vince): who recommends the agency at discharge?	26	"and, while a neuro diagnosed my dad with parkinson's dementia, a hospital visit indicated suspicion for lewy body dementia, with recommendation for further testing." (reddit post, 170) https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tkrjqf/both_of_my_parents_are_on_hospice/

FEELING — what she will be feeling

Line (Vince)	Docs	Verbatim example
Exhausted / overwhelmed / burnt out	541	"I had lunch with her or took her shopping almost every day because I knew she needed me, but I was also exhausted." (reddit post, 1300) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comment/s/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/
Not what I expected	36	"Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again ov" (reddit post, 775) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/
Drowning	23	"If youre a caregiver drowning in toxic positivity..." (reddit post, 427) https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/
How do I afford care	150	"Even with insurance you could be paying more than \$50 an hour for care." (reddit post, 765) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/
The calls from 'specialists' and referral services	28	"Never use "A Place for Mom"." (reddit post, 590) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1kocgug/never_use_a_place_for_mom/
Hearing the complaints and grievances of the parent	112	"I am fine with that and even enjoy it and don't complain about the typical needs, but it's the attitude that is the killer." (youtube, 302) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugxx_YPLbQCkuR7nN8l4AaABAg
A living nightmare / living hell	171	"Dementia would be my own worst nightmare, and having to be face to face with it day after day is something I'm now dealing with in therapy." (reddit post, 1034) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s1ggmt/npr_story_on_caring_for_aging_parents_venting/
One more thing on her plate: supplies, the medicine, being called	167	"My husband had a stroke at 61 and I was changing diapers for 2 years with no help and using the Lahoya lift many times a day." (youtube, 956) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgztYmazblhZwkmWogF4AaABAg
Marriage, kids at home, a life already stretched thin	654	"My husband had a stroke at 61 and I was changing diapers for 2 years with no help and using the Lahoya lift many times a day." (youtube, 956) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgztYmazblhZwkmWogF4AaABAg
Leaving her job / sacrificing her income	132	"I've suffered loss of income and freedom... I'm sorry to say this, especially as a Christian, but I have developed resentment towards my own mother 😞" (youtube, 801) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxNpHmATs-JZOZZnJp4AaABAg
Keeping the parents safe	144	"He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home." (reddit post, 387) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/
Guilt and regret	386	"I carried enormous guilt over that conflict." (reddit post, 1300) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/
Resentment towards the aging parent	232	"I hated admitting it, but I began to resent it." (reddit post, 1300) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/
Life on hold / wanting her own life back	77	"My mother died last year, and I've been piecing my life back together." (reddit post, 1034) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s1ggmt/npr_story_on_caring_for_aging_parents_venting/

Line (Vince)	Docs	Verbatim example
Relief that the suffering can stop	70	“Zero relief.” (reddit post, 406) https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/
The distance	153	“Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of ” (reddit post, 775) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/
I don't want to do this anymore	77	“I'm done thinking about my mother.” (reddit post, 1034) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s1sgmt/npr_story_on_caring_for_aging_parents_venting/
Society: 'who else will do it', smile through suffering	205	“You can be grateful they're alive while mourning the person they used to be.” (reddit post, 1300) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/
Anger	219	“i'm furious with him.” (reddit post, 498) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/
Want some peace / to be left alone / just want it to stop	35	“The physical demands, time demands, need for supervision, they can hardly be left alone, managing them such as redirecting their attention away from something setting them off, etc.” (youtube, 302) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugxx_YPLbQCkuR7nN8I4AaABAg
Unbearable / it's killing me	39	“However she had her eyes wide open, wouldn't stop rocking back and forth, bending her legs, and it dawned on me that she must have been in unbearable pain.” (reddit post, 519) https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die_update_shes/
Alone: no help, no sibling or spouse support, only child	224	“Im an only child and am looking after my parents.” (youtube, 626) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzFmmlzwwUilqQ93KF4AaABAg

DO NOT USE — the empty words

Line (Vince)	Docs	Verbatim example
'You're so strong'	17	“You're So Strong = You're On Your Own: A Caregiver Translation Guide.” (reddit post, 427) https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/
'God gives us only what we can handle'	6	“God only gives you what you can handle Translation: Your suffering doesnt matter because Ive decided it has a purpose.” (reddit post, 427) https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/
'Your mom is lucky to have you'	18	“Here's what people told me: "You're so strong." "God only gives us what we can handle." "Your mom is lucky to have you." You know what actually helped?” (reddit post, 406) https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/
Fake positivity, 'be strong', 'be grateful', 'smile through it'	188	“You can be grateful they're alive while mourning the person they used to be.” (reddit post, 1300) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/

Line (Vince)	Docs	Verbatim example
People who condemn the empty words (evidence the villain is real)	19	"I'm just a tired miserable 40 year-old woman who has spent the last 3 years in constant fight-or-flight mode, fielding phonecalls and unsolicited opinions and unhelpful platitudes from people who seem to have conveniently forgot that dementia doesn't get better" (reddit post, 479) https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/

VIVID — lines to use

Line (Vince)	Docs	Verbatim example
Drowning in butt cream, doctors' appointments and diapers	6	"If you're a caregiver drowning in toxic positivity..." (reddit post, 427) https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/
Took the phone out of the wall / can't take another 'checking on us' call	5	"I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just 'checking on us' only to be unavailable when I ask for help." (reddit comment, 95) https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nobb2tw/
Mourning the person they used to be	8	"You can be grateful they're alive while mourning the person they used to be." (reddit post, 1300) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/
Hear from people who've been there	143	"If you're in the thick of caring for an aging parent, and you're feeling burned out, resentful, guilty, or conflicted... Please know you're not alone." (reddit post, 1300) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/
The bathrooms, the sheets, the appointments, the pills	412	"My husband had a stroke at 61 and I was changing diapers for 2 years with no help and using the Lahoya lift many times a day." (youtube, 956) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzYmazblhZwkmWogF4AaABAq

RELIEF — outcomes to promise

Line (Vince)	Docs	Verbatim example
I can finally breathe	3	"I can finally breathe." (reddit post, 387) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/
I can recover / take care of myself	198	"I used to think I might 'get my life back,' but I've found that you don't." (reddit post, 1034) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s1ggmt/npr_story_on_caring_for_aging_parents_venting/
Best thing we ever did	45	"Put a camera in their room if they are in a facility - best thing I did." (reddit post, 138) https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1qnu02i/put_a_camera_in_their_room_if_they_are_in_a/
Peace of mind	94	"Without a peace of mind your mind becomes resentful, angered, stressed, suicidal and hateful." (reddit comment, 23) https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nocgdi5/
Above and beyond	93	"You went above and beyond." (reddit comment, 126) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/o5c6q3f/

Line (Vince)	Docs	Verbatim example
A peaceful end, no regrets	94	"I wish she had gone peacefully." (reddit post, 519) https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die_update_shes/
Sleep through the night	23	"I want to S-L-E-E-P through the night without having to get up and go find his glasses under his own a\$\$!!!" (reddit post, 411) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p5trpx/i_despise_my_dad_for_making_me_his_caregiver/
A way that doesn't bankrupt us	320	"She won't go back to Poland, her retirement won't be more than \$1,300/month so she won't be able to afford her apartment." (reddit post, 455) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mtnn23/shes_going_to_trap_me_in_soon_my_adult_life_is/
Want my life back	26	"My mother died last year, and I've been piecing my life back together." (reddit post, 1034) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s1ggmt/npr_story_on_caring_for_aging_parents_venting/
Mom to stay home safely and accept help	66	"He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home." (reddit post, 387) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/
Permission to be a daughter again	38	"I officially give you permission to go on this vacation." (reddit comment, 339) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tp9u65/should_we_cancel_a_family_trip_because_our_dad_is_oo725vy/

FEARS — keywords and phrases

Line (Vince)	Docs	Verbatim example
Almost killed me / you lose yourself / still exhausted	11	"It almost killed me." (youtube, 1123) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxBCru86SBHWgrVpXB4AaABAg
Not what I expected: thought I'd bring a meal and drive to appointments	11	"Its not what i expected." (youtube, 626) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzFmmlzwwUilqQ93KF4AaABAg
Living hell	25	"I thought id would be bringing a meal over and taking them to appointments but the truth is its a living hell." (youtube, 626) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzFmmlzwwUilqQ93KF4AaABAg
Can't sleep, shop or do chores because mom would wander; garbage disposal; metal in the microwave	49	"Ever since that day, I've replayed every impatient sigh, every time I wished she'd stop calling, every moment I wanted my own freedom instead of another afternoon wandering Target." (reddit post, 1300) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/
Bank accounts drained by 24/7 care	187	"Like many of you here, my Mom (87) muddled through life without any plans: No savings/investments, progressive physical decline, a run-down house, etc." (reddit post, 684) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1m7kjkv/moved_mom_into_assisted_living/
There's no You anymore, even after they pass	7	"There's no You anymore." (youtube, 1123) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxBCru86SBHWgrVpXB4AaABAg

Line (Vince)	Docs	Verbatim example
Waitlist while mom is hallucinating and wandering	40	““We don't specialize in dementia.” “We're not taking new patients right now.” “You're on a waiting list!” “Our waiting list is full, and requesting to be placed on the waiting list doesn't guarantee that you'll be placed on the waiting list - you'll have to wa” (reddit post, 479) https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/

HOPE — keywords and phrases

Line (Vince)	Docs	Verbatim example
Be the daughter again, not the nurse; 'I did the best for her' / 'did the right thing'	26	“We took care of them and did the best we could as their children.” (youtube, 495) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKHiKEw&lc=UgxmGaYBi5Usb_cUYy54AaABAg
What kind of daughter this makes me	2	“Maybe it makes me a terrible person but I cannot do this any longer.” (reddit post, 138) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1np0dlg/grandmother_is_now_refusing_al_or_moving_in_with/
'I have peace', 'I am at peace', 'peace of mind'	30	“She's at peace now.” (reddit post, 370) https://www.reddit.com/r/Alzheimers/comments/1toi567/done/
Devotion	55	“I did everything out of love.” (youtube, 108) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxL7cARs1CHkPqGFQ14AaABAg
Want her to be safe	31	“Everything we could think of to try to keep her safe.” (reddit post, 226) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tszraf/moms_fall_changed_everything_and_im_fuming/
Wants to live in her own home	62	“I can't even describe the pain I'm in right now, but I wanted to let you all know that you've helped me a lot, and I'm glad I pushed through long enough to let her die at home with us.” (reddit post, 519) https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die_update_shes/
Not totally failing at caregiving	7	“Seriously, before you hurt her, or yourself, please don't feel like a failure or horrible child- it's time to wave the white flag.” (reddit comment, 31) https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1nh2anj/what_happens_when_you_cant_do_this_anymore/ne8m2de/

NOT our targets (Vince) — how big are they anyway

Line (Vince)	Docs	Verbatim example
'Something is off with mom': repeating stories, unopened mail, the first fall she hid	5	“She started repeating the same stories over and over.” (reddit post, 1300) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/
'Mom can't live alone', Googling at 1am, doesn't know what home care includes	10	“But when she started having hallucinations and delusions that made my husband and I agree that it wasn't safe for her to live alone (which coincided with her friends ALSO saying she shouldn't live alone), I gave her a fucking choice - I asked if she wanted to” (reddit post, 479) https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/

Line (Vince)	Docs	Verbatim example
Comparing quotes from six agencies	1	"We called six agencies, got wildly different quotes, had zero idea how to compare them, and the agency we ended up with took two weeks just to send us a contract." (reddit post, 29) https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1rk3gby/what_are_you_actually_paying_for_your_home_care/
'\$5/hr more, I don't have to interview anyone'	5	"We're paying \$30/hr to an agency I considered care.com but for \$5/hr more i don't have to interview anyone or any of that legwork I'm nervous." (reddit comment, 10) https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/okudadt/

The line (added by Vince, 2026-09-07)

You're not failing because you can't keep smiling, the system is failing you. You don't need inspirational quotes. You need respite care.

Provenance: this is her voice almost word for word. r/CaregiverSupport, "Dear toxic positivity society: Shove your fake words and fix the respite care system", 406 upvotes: "To every caregiver who's exhausted: Your anger is valid. You're not failing because you can't keep smiling. The SYSTEM is failing you. You don't need better coping skills. You need systemic change. You don't need inspirational quotes. You need affordable respite care." (https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/). Its sibling, 427 upvotes, the "You're so strong = you're on your own" post: "I don't need your theology. I need respite care." (https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/). Those two posts are the highest-engaged manifestos in the corpus and they name the villain (empty words) and the product (respite) in the same breath.

Role in the approach: the manifesto line, the anti-platitude position, and the front-end product in one sentence. If the ad says "you need respite care," the first thing she can buy has to be respite in the literal sense: a night off, a weekend, the first four hours she has had to herself, with the same caregiver coming back. The corpus's respite theme is 169 documents and "I want to sleep through the night" is the second-largest desired outcome; a respite-first offer under this line is the most direct match between the message and what she says she wants.

What the check says (my read, labeled)

- **The "when" holds.** "Stubborn parent refusing help" (381) and "tried to do it herself first" (379) are two of the largest first-person themes in the corpus; "fired an agency / no-show" is smaller in her posts (29) but is the #2 complaint theme in the Dislikes ledger (80 documents across reviews and posts).
- **On the discharge moment.** The corpus does not measure facility contracts directly. What it shows: at discharge the social worker or case manager is the one who recommends (Google reviews: "the hospital case worker recommended Home Instead"), A Place for Mom is paid a month's rent by the community it places into, and only 2% of proven home care ads sell the post-hospital week. All three are consistent with Vince's call to enter later.

- **The feelings are the heaviest themes in the data:** marriage / kids / stretched thin 654, exhausted 541, guilt 386, alone 224, anger 219, "society says" 205, living nightmare 171, one more thing on her plate 167, the distance 153, how to afford it 150.
- **Every vivid line exists verbatim:** "I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just 'checking on us' only to be unavailable when I ask for help" (95); "drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep" (95); "I can finally breathe" (387); "You're on a waiting list!" (479).
- **The villain is documented:** 188 first-person documents carry the empty words, and 19 name them as the problem ("In three decades I've learned to translate caregiver platitudes", 427; "Dear toxic positivity society: shove your fake words and fix the respite care system", 406; "unhelpful platitudes from people who seem to have conveniently forgot that dementia doesn't get better", 479).
- **The excluded segments are small in this corpus** (5, 10, 1, 5 documents): the corpus was pulled around the caregiving verbs, so early-awareness voices are under-sampled here; that supports leaving them out of these ads without saying they do not exist.

Next in the sequence (not started): offer → copy → landing page → ads, each built from this brief and the 10-tab, per the standing order.